

AI-driven competitive advantage: the role of personality traits and organizational culture in key account management

Prashant Mehta

Symbiosis Centre for Management Studies Noida – Symbiosis International (Deemed University), Noida, India

Debarun Chakraborty

Indian Institute of Management Nagpur, Nagpur, India

Nripendra P. Rana

Queen's Business School, Queen's University Belfast, Belfast, UK and Chandragupt Institute of Management Patna, Patna, India

Anubhav Mishra

Jaipuria Institute of Management Lucknow, Lucknow, India

Sangeeta Khorana

College of Business and Social Sciences, Aston University, Birmingham, UK, and

Kaouther Kooli

Faculty of Management, Bournemouth University Business School, Poole, UK

Abstract

Purpose – The importance of key account management (KAM) as a management technique in business-to-business markets has grown in recent years. The success of KAM programmes is highly dependent on the efforts of individual employees, specifically key account managers. Research on KAM at an individual level is important but lacking in the academic domain. This study aims to fill this gap by developing and evaluating a model of key account manager personality traits and how they impact the adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) technologies. The study also depicts the effect of the adoption of AI technologies on competitive advantage and firm performance.

Design/methodology/approach – The study examines how the adoption of AI technologies impacts firms' competitive advantage and performance. The study used competitive advantage as a mediator and organisational culture as a moderator. A mixed-method analysis was used to conduct the study. In the first phase, an exploratory study was conducted using interviews with 26 key account managers from the automobile industry and thematic analysis to establish 9 constructs. In the second phase, which is a confirmatory study, 496 respondents finally responded to the questionnaire.

Findings – All constructs are used for confirmatory analysis and validate the data. Our research shows that key account managers' adoption of AI technologies is influenced significantly by personality traits. Extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness have substantial links to adopting AI technologies, which impacts firms' competitive advantage and performance. Organisational culture significantly moderates the association between agreeableness and the adoption of AI technologies.

Practical implications – The findings of this research allow organisations to optimise team composition, customise training programs based on individual traits and incorporate personality assessments into recruitment processes for streamlined technology adoption and improved competitiveness. Overall, these actions aim to enhance AI integration, driving competitive advantage and client satisfaction.

Originality/value – This study stands out as one of the limited inquiries examining how the Big-five personality traits of key account managers influence the integration of AI technologies and its resulting impact on company performance. Therefore, this research makes notable contributions to the realms of organisational psychology and technology adoption studies.

Keywords Big 5 personality traits, KAM, Competitive advantage, Firm performance

Paper type Research paper

The current issue and full text archive of this journal is available on Emerald
Insight at: <https://www.emerald.com/insight/0885-8624.htm>



Journal of Business & Industrial Marketing
40/2 (2025) 543–569
© Emerald Publishing Limited [ISSN 0885-8624]
[DOI 10.1108/JBIM-03-2024-0205]

Received 26 March 2024
Revised 22 April 2024
20 June 2024
9 August 2024
17 October 2024
12 December 2024
Accepted 8 January 2025

1. Introduction

Although, presently artificial intelligence (AI) is being used with number of business-to-consumer interfaces and has received considerable attention from the market research community (Dwivedi *et al.*, 2023; Liu, 2020; Upadhyay *et al.*, 2022), the application of AI in business-to-business (B2B) market has only recently captured the attention of researchers (Božič and Dimovski, 2019; Herhausen *et al.*, 2020, 2022; Kumar *et al.*, 2019). While factors were identified based on the qualitative study acknowledged the significance and advantages of adopting AI in B2B context and have reported that adoption is influenced by organisational readiness and culture (AlSheibani *et al.*, 2020; Cao *et al.*, 2021; Latinovic and Chatterjee, 2022; Rahman *et al.*, 2023), availability of resources (Cao *et al.*, 2021), perceived ease of use, perceived usefulness and price value (Chatterjee *et al.*, 2021; Dubey *et al.*, 2020), performance and effort expectancy (Cao *et al.*, 2021) and managerial support and attitude (AlSheibani *et al.*, 2020; Cao *et al.*, 2021; Dubey *et al.*, 2020; Latinovic and Chatterjee, 2022). While acknowledging the role of managerial support and attitude, the earlier research has ignored the role of personality. Previous research in psychology suggests that personality is a reflection towards understanding why and how one thinks, feels and behaves in a specific way under different circumstances and situations (Kenrick and Funder, 1988; Moskowitz, 1994) and that it acts as a lens through which one views his/her surroundings comprising people, objects and events in them (Moskowitz, 1994). Therefore, when faced with AI an individual's orientation towards different cues/stimuli in the environment (such as novelty, complexity and functionality) is likely to affect his/her attitude towards AI. The present research attempts to plug this gap and intends to examine the role of personality in influencing AI adoption.

In B2B environment, firms manage a variety of customers with differing business prospects and opportunities (Sandesh *et al.*, 2023). The success in B2B market depends upon creating and nurturing deep-rooted relationships by addressing specific customer demands through value creation. This technique of managing high-profile customers based on relationships that are nurtured through value-creation (Guesalaga *et al.*, 2018; Murphy and Coughlan, 2018; Ulaga, 2003) leading to customer satisfaction and loyalty (Tzempelikos and Gounaris 2013, 2015; Woodall, 2003) has gained considerable traction and high acceptance in B2B business (Božič and Dimovski, 2019; Herhausen *et al.*, 2020, 2022; Kumar *et al.*, 2019). Accordingly, key account management (KAM) has emanated as a reliable relationship management tool that has helped B2B business in cultivating and deepening long-term customer focussed business relationships (Badawi *et al.*, 2022; Ivens and Pardo, 2007; Pardo *et al.*, 2014) by facilitating value creation (Pardo *et al.*, 2006; Salojärvi and Saarenketo, 2013; Sengupta *et al.*, 2000; Sharma, 2006; Sheth and Parvatiyar, 1995).

Addressing the complex customer needs through value-creation in B2B business follows a long transaction cycle involving gathering information from the suppliers, customers and downstream value chain (Salojärvi and Saarenketo, 2013). Furthermore, transactions of many firms have shifted to electronic mode, leading to generation of vast structured (such as sales data and customer information) and unstructured (such as

pictures and videos) data characterised by high volume, velocity and variety (Paschen *et al.*, 2019) which needs to be analysed on a real-time basis for accuracy and meaningfulness of the results (Sandesh *et al.*, 2023). AI can assist in uncovering, organising, analysing, capturing in-depth knowledge about the customers and identifying hidden patterns from this vast data set thereby helping the organisations in formulating effective strategies to close the deals quickly (Martínez-López and Casillas, 2013; Moradi and Dass, 2022; Singh *et al.*, 2019; Syam and Sharma, 2018) and shorten the transaction cycle as compared to their competitors. Therefore, adoption of AI technologies is likely to offer a distinct competitive advantage to the firms and help them in improving their performance (Hossain *et al.*, 2020; Rahman *et al.*, 2023).

Technology–organisation–environment (TOE) framework is one of the models that forms theoretical backbone of the current research. According to TOE framework, technology adoption depends upon the nature of technology (functionality, complexity and compatibility with the existing systems), organisation (top management support, organisational culture such as innovative or customer-centric, size, etc.) and the environment (government regulations, competition, etc.) (Neumann *et al.*, 2024). The organisation component of the TOE framework represents the context in which the technology is being used (Awa *et al.*, 2015a; Mohtaramzadeh *et al.*, 2018; Neumann *et al.*, 2024). Organisational culture, often referred to as shared assumptions, values and beliefs within the organisational members (Liu *et al.*, 2010) represents one such significant context. It has been argued that different organisational cultures often have different underlying values, assumptions and beliefs that directly or indirectly influences technology adoption in firms (Mohtaramzadeh *et al.*, 2018). Furthermore, it has been argued that organisational culture influences individual willingness to accept and/or use technology (Dasgupta and Gupta, 2019; Melitski *et al.*, 2010). As such, it can be concluded that organisational culture may strengthen or weaken the influence of antecedent variables on technology adoption as well as its use. The present study, therefore, discusses organisational culture as a moderating variable.

Innovation is driving the global market as well as workplace by curating solutions to the challenges that the organisations face. However, reluctance on the part of business to adopt these new technological innovations may result in considerable costs in the form of loss of competitive advantage and revenue loss (Makkonen *et al.*, 2016). Although, organisational, market and economic factors have been frequently used to examine technology adoption, psychological factors can also act as significant barriers or facilitators to corporate or institutional technology adoption (Knobloch and Mercure, 2016; Makkonen *et al.*, 2016). These are, however, studied to a lesser extent (Roberts *et al.*, 2021). The term “psychological” relates to gamut of factors relating to the mind and behaviour (Kenrick and Funder, 1988; Moskowitz, 1994). Factoring in psychological aspect brings into focus the role of individual decision makers who take a call whether a technology is to be introduced (or not). In B2B context, this individual is a central figure who takes decision on behalf of the organisation (Roberts *et al.*, 2021). These “gatekeepers” make the pivotal decisions to appraise, trial or adopt technologies for deployment in their organisations and are often located at key positions with power

to make a significant impact upon the success or failure of adoption (Roberts *et al.*, 2021). Understanding how psychological factors influence adoption of innovative technologies is crucial to support the successful introduction of new systems and products (Roberts *et al.*, 2021), that can address the challenges that an organisation is facing and provide distinct competitive edge over its competitors.

This study is as such aimed at investigating the relationship between Big-five personality traits and firm performance as well as competitive advantage with adoption of AI as a mediator in the context of KAM. Organisational culture is considered as a moderating variable. The research seeks to address the following questions:

- RQ1.* How the Big-five personality traits of key account managers are affecting the adoption of AI technologies which simultaneously impact the competitive advantage and firm performance?
- RQ2.* How the organisational culture (moderator) is affecting the relationship between Big-five personality traits and AI adoption, as also the relationship between AI adoption and competitive advantage along with firm performance?

Against this background the present study attempts to investigate the relationship between Big-five personality traits and firm performance as well as competitive advantage with adoption of AI as a mediator in the context of KAM. Organisational culture is considered as a moderating variable.

2. Literature review

Organisations are investing a significant portion of their budget on high-profile solutions to cater to their most strategic and valuable customers (Nätti *et al.*, 2006; Salojärvi and Sainio, 2010; Sandesh *et al.*, 2023). These solutions focus on human capabilities and knowledge-intensive business exchanges (i.e. KAM). Scholars from varied disciplines acknowledge that businesses are no longer viewed from an industrial perspective but are seen from knowledge perspective (Grant, 1996; Paschen *et al.*, 2019; Spender and Grant, 1996). An in-depth understanding of the customer value expectations and the ability to mobilise this knowledge in the organisation are the key factors for the performance of KAM (Kleinaltenkamp *et al.*, 2022; Kumar *et al.*, 2019; Sandesh *et al.*, 2023). This is particularly evident with respect to data, information and knowledge, which help the organisations to extract comparative competitive advantages and drive innovation (Campbell, 2003; Hakanen, 2014). In case of KAM, AI can help translate (big) data into information and knowledge required for creating effective marketing and sales strategies and tactics. The practitioners, thus, expect that AI will assist in personalisation, customisation, innovation and enhanced marketing effectiveness and efficiencies (Moradi and Dass, 2022; Paschen *et al.*, 2019).

KAMs often need a certain combination of characteristics to thrive in their respective positions (Hakanen, 2014; Lai and Yang, 2017; Ellis and Iwasaki, 2018). Elevated degrees of extraversion and agreeableness are often seen as advantageous characteristics due to their facilitation of proficient

communication, establishment of rapport and settlement of conflicts with significant clientele (Hakanen, 2014; Lai and Yang, 2017). Conscientiousness is a crucial trait that guarantees meticulousness and dependability in the management of intricate financial records. Moreover, possessing a modest degree of openness to experience might help KAMs in effectively adjusting to evolving client demands and market dynamics (Guenzi and Storbacka, 2015; Tzempelikos and Gounaris, 2015). In addition, it is necessary to possess emotional stability or exhibit low levels of neuroticism to effectively navigate the stress and strain associated with overseeing crucial client relationships (Guenzi and Storbacka, 2015; Tzempelikos and Gounaris, 2015; Speakman and Ryals, 2012). When KAMs exhibit these characteristics, there is a higher probability of cultivating customer loyalty, driving revenue development and favourably influencing the overall performance of the company via the assurance of client happiness and the establishment of long-term relationships (Hakanen, 2014; Lai and Yang, 2017; Pereira *et al.*, 2019). Hence, organisations that acknowledge the importance of these personality qualities in their KAMs are more likely to attain long-term success in their respective markets.

In B2B markets, the significance of KAM has been recognised as an important research area (Leischnig *et al.*, 2018; Mahlamäki *et al.*, 2019). While extensive literature exists for organisational level themes like, KAM teams (Hakanen, 2014; Lai and Yang, 2017), KAM implementation (Guenzi and Storbacka, 2015; Tzempelikos and Gounaris, 2015), relationship management (Ivens *et al.*, 2016; Ivens and Pardo, 2007; Ryals and Davies, 2013; Salojärvi *et al.*, 2010) and related conceptual models (Guenzi *et al.*, 2007; Homburg *et al.*, 2002; Jones *et al.*, 2005), relatively limited research exists on the role of individual level factors that may impact KAM.

Research on individual level factors has primarily focussed on topics such as behaviours and skills (Davies and Ryals, 2013; Guenzi *et al.*, 2007), and limited research examines psychological factors such as personality (Mahlamäki *et al.*, 2019). Like other professionals, key account managers have different personalities that can impact their performance and eventually firm performance. While the role of personality has gained prominence in the area of industrial marketing (Anaza and Nowlin, 2017; Johnson and Sohi, 2017; McCarthy Byrne *et al.*, 2011; Sok *et al.*, 2016; Tuncdogan *et al.*, 2015) this is largely neglected in KAM and limited studies focus on the relationship between personality and individual performance (Mahlamäki *et al.*, 2019). Further, while studies investigate the role of personality on firm's performance (O'Reilly *et al.*, 2014; Oh *et al.*, 2015; Shalender and Yadav, 2019), a review of literature indicates lack of any study that explores the relationship in the context of KAM. This research gap warrants the need for studies on role of personality in KAM.

People have the tendency to display differing levels of favour or disfavour towards AI (Gaudiello *et al.*, 2016; Shank *et al.*, 2019; Waytz *et al.*, 2010). These orientations regarding favour and disfavour are based on one's cognitive, affective and behavioural evaluations of the entity. These evaluations in turn determine how one feels and thinks about it and what he/she intends to do with it (Eagly and Chaiken, 2007). Previous studies indicate that one's attitudes towards technology are

significant predictors of its acceptance and usage (Marangunić and Granić, 2015) and as such it is important to examine how individuals differ in these attitudes. In the present study we are attempting to understand how personality influences AI adoption of AI.

Psychological research indicates that personality presents an effective framework towards understanding why and how one thinks, feels and behaves in a particular manner under different circumstances and situations (Kenrick and Funder, 1988; Moskowitz, 1994) and that it acts as a lens through which one views his/her surroundings comprising people, objects and events in them (Moskowitz, 1994). Therefore, when faced with AI an individual's orientation towards different cues/stimuli in the environment (such as novelty, complexity and functionality) is likely to affect his/her attitude towards AI. Personality traits are primary determinants of attitudes as they represent variations in sensitivity to different stimuli (Gray, 1973). Since, AI is a novel stimuli that has social, emotional and functional aspects (Gaudiello et al., 2016; Shank et al., 2019; Waytz et al., 2010), therefore, personality traits are likely to determine the extent to which individuals will exhibit certain attitudes towards it. Some of the previous studies have indicated that people's personality features have considerable influence on their attitudes towards autonomous technology (Stein et al., 2019) and interaction with robots (Santamaria and Nathan-Roberts, 2017).

AI has been defined as "a system's ability to correctly interpret external data, to learn from such data, and to use those learnings to achieve specific goals and tasks through flexible adaptation" (Kaplan and Haenlein, 2019, p. 15). Besides other businesses, B2B business has not escaped from the fundamental changes accompanying the advent of AI. The traditional business is facing challenges due to rapidly changing customer preferences, a longer sales process that is influenced by multiple actors and fluidity in the markets (Chen et al., 2022). It is anticipated that AI may influence B2B business through personalisation, customisation, acting as a power source to negotiate competitive advantage (Keegan et al., 2022) and enhanced marketing effectiveness and efficiency (Keegan et al., 2024; Paschen et al., 2019; Wei and Pardo, 2022). While, organisational, market and economic factors have been frequently used to examine technology adoption, psychological factors can also act as significant barriers or facilitators to corporate or institutional technology adoption (Knobloch and Mercure, 2016; Makkonen et al., 2016). Previous research has indicated that technology's *a priori* acceptability and intention to use is influenced by attitudes (Albarracín et al., 2005; Bhat et al., 2022; Parasuraman et al., 1993).

This paper aims to bridge this gap and intends to investigate how personality traits influence AI adoption. In doing so, our article contributes to the literature on AI and personality traits while addressing the call for more scholarly work in this area. The study adopts a mixed-method approach. The first phase of the study involved exploratory analysis to explore the various themes from the interviews. The second phase focussed on empirical analysis to buttress these relationships. The resource-based view (RBV) of the firm and conceptualisation of personality in line with big-five personality traits form the theoretical background of the study. The remaining sections of the paper are organised as introduction to theoretical

background in section 3, research design in section 4, exploratory analysis to explore the relationship between variables in section 5, followed by development of hypothesis in section 6, data analysis in section 6.9, discussion in section 7, theoretical and practical implications in section 8 and 9, and conclusion in section 11.

3. Theoretical background

While factors were identified based on the qualitative study, the theoretical background of the study was based on Big-five personality model, TOE model and RBV of the firm. Using big-five personality model, we examine the influence of five personality traits – namely, extraversion, agreeableness, neuroticism, openness to change and conscientiousness on attitudes towards AI adoption. Researchers in the area of human-computer interaction have frequently used big-five traits (Santamaria and Nathan-Roberts, 2017). Personality traits are primary determinants of attitudes as they represent variations in sensitivity to different stimuli (Gray, 1973). Since, AI is a novel stimuli that has social, emotional and functional aspects (Gaudiello et al., 2016; Shank et al., 2019; Waytz et al., 2010), therefore, personality traits are likely to determine the extent to which individuals will exhibit certain attitudes towards it.

TOE-based model stresses that adoption of new technology is influenced by nature of the technology itself, including its functionality, complexity, compatibility with existing systems and ease of use. Organisation refers to the internal context in which the technology is used including culture (top management support), change management, innovative culture, organisational size, financial and human resources. Environment refers to competitive pressure, government regulations and industry requirements (Neumann et al., 2024).

In general, it is acknowledged that technology adoption explanation at the individual and organisational level requires two different set of theories. While behavioural theories such as technology acceptance model, theory of planned behaviour and unified theory of acceptance and use of technology have been frequently used to explain technology adoption at the individual level, theories and models like diffusion of innovation and TOE framework have been used at the organisational level. Although, this segregation of theories appears to be reasonable and logical, however, the process of investigating the organisation is ultimately performed based on gathering opinion of the individuals. Also, there are no established criteria regarding how to fairly obtain the organisational characteristics when organisation is the target of investigation. These organisational characteristics may include readiness to adopt technology, perceived advantages, competitive edge etc. In the absence of proven methodology to fairly identify these organisational characteristics, the researchers frequently choose to survey decision makers who have the authority to approve final purchase (Kuan and Chau, 2001; Oliveira and Martins, 2010). Furthermore, these decision makers may have different assessments of these organisational characteristics, underscoring the role of individual perceptions. Therefore, it can be said that the adoption of technology in the organisational context depends upon the perception of key decision makers towards it.

As the key account managers play a pivotal role in the handling of high-volume customers of the firm, they play a significant role in decision-making (Georges and Eggert, 2003; Pardo *et al.*, 2020). Infact it has been suggested that decision-making process suffers if key account managers lack decision-making authority (Larson and Gobeli, 1988). The orientation of these decisions may be influenced by their perceptions towards firm level characteristics. Previous studies under different contexts have indicated that personality has a significant influence on perception (Caligiuri, 2000; Judge and Zapata, 2015; Saksvik and Hetland, 2011). The present research borrows the conceptualisation of organisation from the TOE based model and combines it with Big-five personality trait model to achieve its overall objective of investigating the role of Big-five personality traits on technology adoption in the organisational context.

The RBV conceptualises the firm as a bundle of resources and these resources account for the growth or decline of the firm (Penrose, 1959). Resources may include technical know-how, assets, capabilities, processes, culture and attributes that are possessed by the firm and these help the firm to formulate and implement competitive strategies (Barney, 1991). RBV relies on two basic assertions, that of resource heterogeneity and resource immobility. If a resource possessed by a firm is also possessed by other firms, this resource cannot contribute to competitive advantage. Heterogeneity is an essential condition for enjoying at least temporary competitive advantage. Resource immobility is the required condition for enjoying long-term competitive advantage, since competitors would face cost disadvantages in obtaining, developing and using it compared to the firm that already possess it (Rivard *et al.*, 2006). Since, adoption of AI is likely to equip the firm with a heterogeneous and immobile resource it may provide distinct competitive advantage to the firm and boost its performance. Also, as organisational culture constitutes a distinct resource for the organisation it may influence the adoption of AI and, hence, moderate the relationship between five personality traits and AI adoption as well as between AI adoption and competitive advantage.

4. Research design

The research used a mixed-methods strategy, including both qualitative and quantitative approaches, to mitigate the potential constraints associated with relying only on a single methodological approach (Venkatesh *et al.*, 2013). Qualitative research techniques, such as interviews and observations, provide comprehensive and detailed understandings of the experiences, perceptions and behaviours of people or groups (Fossey *et al.*, 2002). These approaches enable researchers to delve into the complexities of a given subject matter. In contrast, quantitative methodologies such as surveys provide a higher level of statistical rigour and generalizability, allowing researchers to make more extensive inferences and discern patterns and trends (Finnegan *et al.*, 2019). Through the integration of both the methodologies, mixed-method research offers a more comprehensive and rigorous comprehension of research inquiries, hence augmenting the credibility and dependability of outcomes (Castro *et al.*, 2010).

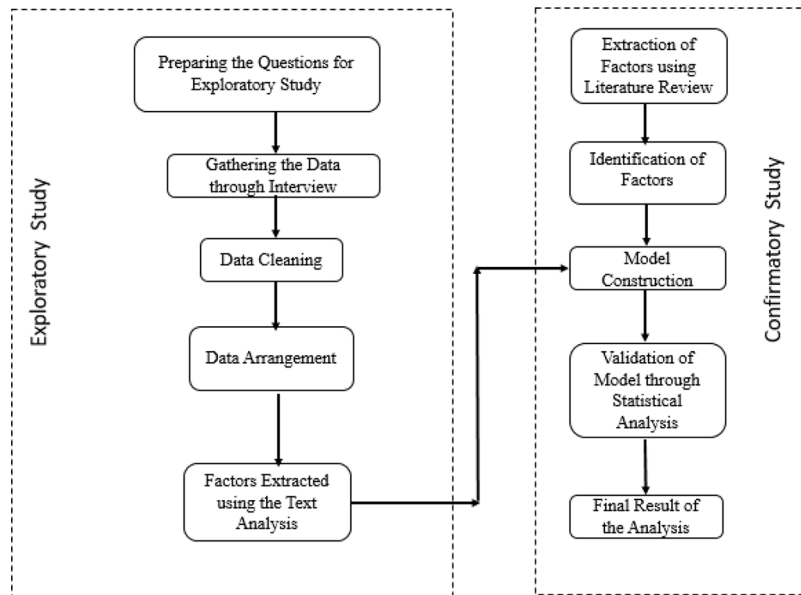
Using a mixed-methods approach is crucial for the study as it delves into the intricate dynamics between human (personality traits) and organisational (culture) factors, in conjunction with technological advancements (AI), within KAM. This design enables researchers to measure the impact of AI and human elements on success, while also capturing the intricate experiences and decision-making processes that shape the implementation of AI and its interaction with company culture and individual personalities. By considering multiple perspectives, a deeper insight can be gained into the optimal utilisation of AI in the unique social environment of KAM.

During the qualitative phase of the exploratory investigation, data analysis was conducted using interview technique. Specifically, theme analysis was performed following text summarisation using Atlas.ti 9. The objective was to discover and analyse significant components. The aforementioned parameters were used for the purpose of identifying theoretical lexicons, which were then subjected to validation in the confirmatory research. The framework under consideration was developed using theoretical lexicons, and afterwards subjected to validation via a cross-sectional confirmatory research. The confirmatory investigation was conducted using a cross-sectional design, using a structured questionnaire. The data analysis was conducted with structural equation modelling (SEM) which provided the final output of the study. Figure 1 illustrates the steps used to conduct the study.

5. Exploratory study (first phase)

The first phase of the study used an inductive research approach and used semi-structured interviews to develop the research model. The data for the qualitative study was collected from National Capital Region of India from the managers working with original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) of automobile industry. All the interviews were conducted by the researchers in English. We have approached around 58 managers, and a total of 26 of them were agree to provide their responses. On an average, each interview lasted for around 40 min. The interviews were conducted in three separate stages. Using an intervention approach, the interviews began with general inquiries and gradually transitioned to more focused ones (Brinkmann, 2013). Attached in Appendix 1 are the comprehensive questions that were used as a reference guide during these interviews. The main interview commenced with interviewers asking the respondents to recall the most critical incidents affecting the firm's performance and its competitive edge over the others. Many of the respondents suggested that their organisation was able to perform better and beat the competition due to timely adoption of newer technologies, like AI based technologies.

All the interviews were recorded and transcribed *verbatim*. A systematic analysis was conducted by applying open coding to excerpts from the qualitative findings. Through careful analysis of the data, patterns were discovered by comparing and contrasting the information. The authors thoroughly analysed the open coding results and carefully examined the data patterns. They then moved on to selective coding to identify and categorise the various themes or dimensions. This was accomplished by thoroughly cross-referencing the data with relevant literature.

Figure 1 Steps used to conduct the study

Source: Authors' own work

The transcripts were coded using thematic analysis (Medisauskaite *et al.*, 2023; Fereday and Muir-Cochrane, 2006). While, thematic analysis prevents separating codes from their context. However, the process of clubbing the text into themes may lead to their disconnection from the overall narrative. Therefore, every transcript was reread by including the codes to holistically understand how each of the constructs was felt by each of the respondents, which has been shown in Appendix 2. The thematic analysis resulted in the emergence of nine themes, from which five personality trait constructs were identified: extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness. Other than this, four more constructs, namely, firm performance, competitive advantage, adoption of AI technologies and organisational culture, have also been extracted from the qualitative responses.

The variables in the study were identified and extracted using a systematic process of thematic analysis applied to the semi-structured interview transcripts (Refer to Appendix). Initially, open coding was used to identify patterns in the data, which helped to reveal key themes and constructs from the responses provided by the managers. We cross-referenced these patterns with existing literature to ensure they aligned with the theoretical framework and were valid. Through thematic analysis, a set of five personality traits were identified including extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness. These traits were found to be significant in understanding managerial behaviours and their impact on organisational outcomes. In addition, we identified several key factors that consistently emerged as critical to the success of firms. These factors include firm performance, competitive advantage, AI technology adoption and organisational culture. This approach guarantees that the extracted variables are relevant to the context and based on empirical evidence, effectively

capturing the intricate dynamics within the automotive OEM sector.

6. Confirmatory study (phase 2): literature review and hypotheses development

The TOE framework (Tornatzky and Fleischer, 1990) indicates that technology adoption is influenced by technology development (Kauffman and Walden, 2001), organisational conditions (Chatterjee *et al.*, 2002) and industry environment (Rao Kowtha and Choon, 2001). The technological factors that can influence adoption include pool of internal and external technologies and their perceived usefulness, technology complexity and learning curve, etc. (Awa *et al.*, 2015a, 2015b). The organisational factors include top management support, organisational culture, organisational structure and human capital (Jeyaraj *et al.*, 2006; Sabherwal *et al.*, 2006). Environment includes facilitators and inhibitors that are external to the organisation like competitive pressure, government policies, technology support infrastructure etc. (Jeyaraj *et al.*, 2006). Previous studies have indicated that organisational and environmental factors are strong predictors of technology adoption as compared to technology-related factors (Chittipaka *et al.*, 2022; Henriksen, 2006).

The primary aim of this study was to examine the role of personality of key account managers in the adoption of AI and evaluate its impact on the overall performance of the firm. Since TOE is the only framework that examines the role of organisational factors in technology adoption, this study borrowed the concept of organisation as explained in the TOE framework to investigate the role of personality and moderating impact of organisational culture on technology adoption in firms. The organisational context in accordance with the TOE framework includes enterprise scope, managerial beliefs and support, organisational culture and complexity of organisational

structure characterised by degree of centralisation, formalisation and vertical differentiation, formal and informal linking structure among employees, intra-organisational communication, the human capital quality, size and size-related issues and specialisation (Awa *et al.*, 2017; Low *et al.*, 2011; Melville and Ramirez, 2008; Salwani *et al.*, 2009; Xu and Lu, 2022).

6.1 Extraversion and artificial intelligence adoption

The organisation component of TOE model focuses on the internal structure, processes and size of the organisation. An organisational structure and culture that is characterised by friendly, family-like atmosphere may provide a fertile ground for people high on extraversion (Gardner *et al.*, 2012). Previous research has indicated that person-organisation fit facilitates adoption of technology (Xu and Lu, 2022). As such extraverted employees in affiliated with an organisation that exhibits a clan-like structure may facilitate AI adoption. Extraverted people are characterised as fun loving, active, affectionate and talkative (Costa and McCrae, 2006). The assumption that AI may replace people in some repetitive jobs suggests that introvert people may favour the adoption of AI (Schepman and Rodway, 2023). On the other hand, a contrasting view suggests that people who are extroverted may have a positive attitude towards adoption of AI as this gives them an opportunity to engage socially and gain attention (Ashton *et al.*, 2002; Schepman and Rodway, 2023). Previous studies have indicated that individuals with high extraversion felt less anxious while communicating through computer-mediated communication technology. In the context of the present study, it is hypothesised that extroverted key account managers may have a more positive outlook towards adoption of AI:

H1. Extraversion is significantly and positively related to AI adoption.

6.2 Agreeableness and artificial intelligence adoption

As stated earlier, an organisational structure and culture that fosters friendly and family like environment characterised by high level of trust and cooperation within members may be an ideal fit for individuals high on agreeableness. Such an organisation person fit may provide a conducive environment for people high on agreeableness to promote AI adoption in their organisations (Xu *et al.*, 2022; Xu and Lu, 2022).

Individuals possessing high degree of agreeableness are characterised as straightforward, trusting, forgiving, helpful and soft hearted. While people at the lower end of the scale are uncooperative, rude, vengeful, irritable and rude (Costa and McCrae, 2006). Studies conducted earlier have reported that people who are socially compliant, trusting and respectful, traits relating to agreeableness, have a positive approach towards technology adoption (Kortum and Oswald, 2018; Lane and Manner, 2011; Shropshire *et al.*, 2015). It could, thus, be argued that key account managers having agreeable personality are likely to have a positive attitude towards adoption of AI:

H2. Agreeableness is significantly and positively related to AI adoption.

6.3 Conscientiousness and artificial intelligence adoption

The hierarchical organisation structure that is characterised by efficiency, stability and reliable performance (Cameron and Quinn, 2011). Previous research has found positive relationship between conscientiousness and attraction to detail and outcome-oriented culture (Judge and Cable, 1997). It is, therefore, expected that conscientious employees will perceive a good fit between this culture and their personality. Past research suggests person-organisation fit aids technology adoption (Xu *et al.*, 2022; Xu and Lu, 2022).

People with high score on conscientiousness are characterised by traits such as strong willed, purposeful, systematic and determined (Costa and McCrae, 2006; Mahlamäki *et al.*, 2019). Earlier research has indicated a positive relationship between conscientiousness and range of technology evaluations (Schepman and Rodway, 2023; Shropshire *et al.*, 2015). Since AI can lead to increase in productivity, it is, therefore, hypothesised that key account managers having high conscientiousness should have a positive orientation towards AI adoption:

H3. Conscientiousness is significantly and positively related to AI adoption.

6.4 Neuroticism and artificial intelligence adoption

Neuroticism refers to the extent to which people are nervous, emotional and insecure (Gardner *et al.*, 2012). As such neurotic persons are prone to respond to stressful situations a negative manner. Earlier findings suggest that such persons are likely to favour a hierarchical structure that is characterised by stability, structure and predictability (Berings *et al.*, 2004). It is, therefore, believed that neurotic individuals who experience appropriate fit with their organisation may aid in adoption of AI (Xu *et al.*, 2022; Xu and Lu, 2022).

In the context of the present study, it is believed that the emotional stability provided to employees high on neuroticism may facilitate adoption of AI. Earlier studies have indicated a positive relationship between emotional stability and attitude towards innovative technologies that are potentially risky (Qu *et al.*, 2021) as well as more generic technologies (Barnett *et al.*, 2015). It is, therefore, hypothesised that key account managers high on neuroticism may approach AI adoption positively under appropriate organisational conditions:

H4. Neuroticism is significantly and positively related to AI adoption.

6.5 Openness and artificial intelligence adoption

Since organisational structure is based on adhocracy values, innovation, flexibility, creativity and entrepreneurship, it is expected that employees those who score high on openness will see a fit between their quest for creativity and novel experiences with this culture. The same has been postulated in earlier studies as well (Judge and Cable, 1997). People scoring high on openness are creative, original, imaginative, creative and unconventional, while people scoring low are conventional, unimaginative and down to earth (Costa and McCrae, 2006; Mahlamäki *et al.*, 2019). Since openness to experience is

associated with inclination towards new sensations and ideas and engagement in intellectual activities (Mahlamäki *et al.*, 2019), it is reasonable to believe that technology as innovative as AI might be viewed positively by open-minded key account managers. The following hypothesis is, therefore, proposed:

- H5. Openness is significantly and positively related to AI adoption.

6.6 Adoption of artificial intelligence technologies

In the present study, it is proposed that AI acts as a mediator between Big-five personality traits and competitive advantage as well as firm performance. Preceding paragraphs have suggested possible relationship between AI adoption and Big-five personality traits. AI has been defined as:

Theories and techniques used to create machines capable of simulating intelligence. AI is a general term that involves the use of a computer to model intelligent behaviour with minimal human intervention (Haenlein and Kaplan, 2019, p. 6).

Earlier studies have reported that organisations have been implementing AI technological initiatives with the purpose of either disrupting or adapting their ecosystem, concomitantly optimising and developing their strategic and competitive advantage (Mishra *et al.*, 2022; Wamba-Taguimdje *et al.*, 2020). It has been reported that AI is able to fully express its potential by virtue of its capability to optimise existing processes, detect, predict and interact with humans thereby improving on performance at both the organisational and process level (Wamba-Taguimdje *et al.*, 2020). It is, therefore, hypothesised that:

- H6. AI adoption has a significant and positive impact on competitive advantage of the firm.
- H7. AI adoption has a significant and positive impact on firm performance.

6.7 Competitive advantage as a mediator and firm performance as dependent variable

Competitive advantage results when an organisation is able to execute value accruing strategy that cannot be concurrently implemented by other competing firms (Kiyabo and Isaga, 2020). RBV indicates that a firm's competitive edge and superior performance results from organisation specific resources that are difficult to copy or imitate, valuable, rare and non-substitutable (Kiyabo and Isaga, 2020). It is further reported that resources include assets, capabilities, organisational processes, information and knowledge (Kiyabo and Isaga, 2020). It can, therefore, be considered that adoption of AI gives distinct competitive advantage to the firm which ultimately translates into firm's overall performance:

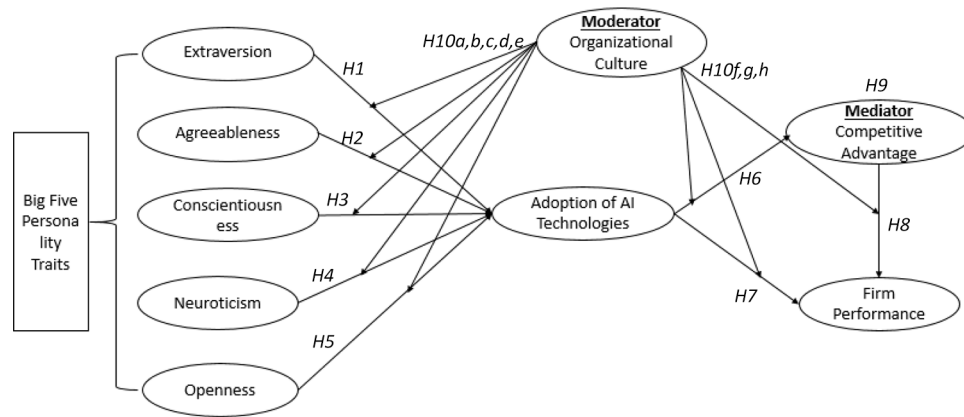
- H8. Competitive advantage has a significant and positive impact upon firm performance.
- H9. Competitive advantage has a mediating influence on adoption of AI technologies and firm performance.

6.8 Organisational culture as a moderator

The organisation component of TOE framework represents, besides, the internal processes, structure and size, the organisational culture as well (Awa and Ojiabo, 2016; Tornatzky and Fleischer, 1990; Xu and Lu, 2022). It has been argued that organisational culture influences individual willingness to accept and/or use technology (Dasgupta and Gupta, 2019; Melitski *et al.*, 2010) and it may strengthen or weaken the influence of antecedent variables on technology adoption as well as its use. In the context of the present study, it is assumed that organisational culture acts as a moderator between Big-five personality traits and AI adoption. It is further proposed that organisational culture moderates the relationship between AI adoption and competitive advantage as well as firm's performance. However, the attention has to be redirected towards the personality's direct role in AI adoption which can be best substantiated with the human resource element of the TOE framework (Occhipinti *et al.*, 2023). With a focus on human resources, the defining framework could also formulate how the dispositions of individuals, such as extraversion, openness or conscientiousness, drive attitudes and decisions concerning AI adoption (Riedl, 2022). It is important to recognise that the adoption of items at the organisational level, in the analysis, has to be moderated by key people within the organisation, such as decision makers and key account managers (El-Kassar and Singh, 2019). When including the human resource view into the TOE model one may provide comprehensive picture of the ways in which personality traits determine the AI adoption behaviour without ignoring the organisational factor (Kumar and Shankar, 2024). More significantly, the integration of the human resource aspect in TOE provides a better viewpoint on the role of the organisational context and the role of an individual in the organisational context who uses AI technology (Chatterjee *et al.*, 2022). Organisational culture has been described as a collection of shared values, beliefs and assumptions that are present in organisational practices and that help the members of the organisation to understand organisational functioning (Liu *et al.*, 2010). It has also been reported that organisational culture affects how an organisational responds to external environment and makes strategic choices (Liu *et al.*, 2010). It is indicated that organisational culture may influence a manager's ability to process information, rationalise and ability to exercise discretion over their decision-making (Berthon *et al.*, 2001). The following hypotheses are proposed:

- H10a,b,c,d,e. Organisational culture moderates the relationship between Big-five personality traits and AI adoption.
- H10f. Organisational culture moderates the relationship between AI adoption and competitive advantage.
- H10g. Organisational culture moderates the relationship between AI adoption and firm performance.
- H10h. Organisational culture moderates the relationship between and competitive advantage and firm performance.

The research model is shown in Figure 2.

Figure 2 Research model

Source: Authors' own work

6.9 Methods for confirmatory study (phase 2)

The automobile industry was chosen as the main focus of this study because of the widespread use of AI throughout its value chain. This includes areas such as manufacturing, design, supply chain management, etc. The industry is going through a significant shift due to the rapid progress in technology and increased competition. The market for AI in automotive applications is expected to experience significant growth in the coming years. Considering the growing acknowledgment of AI's crucial role in various aspects of the automotive industry, such as predictive maintenance and emergency assistance, it was deemed appropriate to conduct this investigation in this context.

This study examined companies operating in India, with a particular interest in various governmental initiatives. These initiatives highlight the country's enthusiasm for adopting Industry 4.0. Although prepared, the extensive implementation of AI in India, like in other countries, is still in its early stages. Therefore, it is crucial to identify the obstacles to AI adoption and understand how it affects the competitive landscape of Indian companies. Representative associations of the automotive manufacturing sector, such as the Auto Components Manufacturers Association of India (ACMA) and the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM), were selected to aid in the selection of our sample. Using their extensive databases, we discovered automobile manufacturers in different regions of India.

A total of 26 medium and large-sized firms were chosen to be part of the study, with a particular focus on those listed on the National Stock Exchange. These companies have significant abilities to adopt new technologies. Our study includes key account managers as participants, within the automotive industry. We reached out to KAMs who hold positions that involve the use of AI applications in these companies, inviting them to take part in our study. Our research relies on insights from experts who are actively involved in implementing AI-based solutions in different areas of the automotive industry. These individuals have valuable knowledge and experience in different areas like manufacturing, design, supply chain management, etc.

A structured questionnaire was used to conduct an online survey to collect data from key account managers (KAM). The study used a descriptive research design and applied a purposive sample strategy to collect the responses of the participants. The questionnaire underwent adaptation and customisation to ensure its alignment with the specific context of the KAMs intention to adopt AI technologies and how it is affecting the competitive advantage and firm performance. This process involved incorporating known scales from the existing literature. The data collection approach used a purposive sample strategy to determine the eligibility of participants. In this regard, a set of questions was administered to possible respondents. The questionnaire was initially disseminated to a sample of 42 who are KAMs, academicians and top managers of other firms for the purpose of evaluating the validity and suitability of the questions. This procedure enabled the alteration of certain inquiries to effectively tackle issues pertaining to language and ambiguity.

We distributed the online survey link through the email, WhatsApp, LinkedIn and Facebook pages of KAMs working in the chosen companies to collect data. In addition, we asked recipients to kindly share the questionnaire with at least 15 contacts who would find it relevant. These studies emphasise the improved response rates achieved through virtual platforms like WhatsApp, Facebook, LinkedIn and email, thanks to the personalised connection between researchers and respondents. By using social networking sites as a sampling framework, researchers can obtain a large and diverse sample size, which improves the representativeness of the sample. The survey instrument was created using the Google Forms platform, which was configured to only accept responses from individuals who met the pre-set inclusion criteria. The authors have used their own sources also from where they have received the responses for the questions and also got some references from them. Hence, with purposive sampling we have used the snowball sampling also. The data collection was conducted between May 2022 and March 2023. The initial screening questions were used to ascertain whether the respondents were KAMs of automobile companies and were using AI concurrently during their work. The screening questions are provided below:

Q1. Are you working as a key account manager in any of the automobile company?

Q2. Is your company using the AI technologies?

If the answer for both the screening questions is “yes”, then only the respondents can see the final questionnaire unless they will be automatically leaving the survey. Of over 2,500 people who were contacted, 496 participants provided their consent to be the respondents in the study by fulfilling the necessary documentation and submitting their responses. A total of 496 responses were collected, as the Google Form used in this study did not permit the submission of incomplete responses. Our sample included individuals who demonstrate variation in gender, economic level and household size. Table 1 presents a thorough representation of the demographic analysis.

There was no significant difference found between early and late respondents in terms of their demographic profiles or study constructs, suggesting that there is no non-response bias present. According to the study conducted by Shankar *et al.* (2020), the findings revealed that there were no notable variations between participants who took the survey early and those who took it late in terms of their demographic characteristics or the variables being studied.

6.10 Data analysis and findings for confirmatory study (phase 2)

Table 2 presents the correlations between different constructs with significance levels. The current study used a two-step technique for data analysis. The study commenced with the implementation of a confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) to evaluate the construct validity and internal consistency reliability of the measurement scales. The research used the SEM methodology to analyse the conceptual framework, using both SPSS 26 and Amos 26 software. In the second step, the moderation test was conducted using the PROCESS Macro 4.0 tool. The initial evaluation of the data included an assessment of missing values, revealing the absence of any such values. Furthermore, an evaluation was conducted to determine the normality of the data, revealing that it conforms to the permissible range of 1–7 (+ and –) for both skewness and kurtosis (Field, 2013).

The values recorded for the study constructs fell within the acceptable range of +3 to –3. The assessment of multicollinearity in the data set involved the calculation of variance inflation factors. These factors were found to be below the

threshold of 3, indicating a satisfactory level of multicollinearity. The researchers used the Harman one-factor test to conduct an exploratory factor analysis to examine the presence of common method bias (CMB). The study's findings suggest that there is a lack of evidence supporting the presence of common technique bias. The findings indicate that less than 50% of the variance can be ascribed to a singular component. A marker variable is added in this study, which was not anticipated to have any correlation with the main variables under investigation. Upon analysing the data, it was discovered that this marker variable had minimal correlation with the other variables used in the study. The low correlation observed in the study indicates that there was no CMB that could have influenced the findings (Shankar *et al.*, 2020). Following the administration of the CMB test, the CFA was used to authenticate the model's validity, as depicted in Table 3. In Appendix 3, we have shown the items for the analysis.

The composite reliability (CR) of each construct demonstrated internal consistency, as indicated by values more than 0.7 (see Table 3). The constructs have exhibited convergent validity, as indicated by average variance extracted (AVE) values surpassing 0.5. Based on the findings of Fornell and Larcker (1981), it is apparent that the latent variables explain at least 50% of the variability found in the indicators associated with them. The assessment of the model's discriminant validity involved the utilisation of several criteria, such as Fornell–Larcker's criterion, the condition that the AVE should exceed the maximum shared variance (MSV) and the implementation of the Heterotrait–Monotrait (HTMT) method. The coefficients pertaining to the other constructs, as indicated in Table 4, demonstrate values that are comparatively lower than the squared AVE, but the AVE values above the MSV. Hence, the constructs presented in this study has been evaluated using the method of convergent and discriminant validity.

Henseler *et al.* (2015) demonstrated that the HTMT technique showed more sensitivity in determining discriminant validity of constructs when compared to the Fornell–Larcker criterion and the assessment of cross-loadings (Table 5). To guarantee the presence of adequate discriminant validity among constructs, it is advisable to maintain HTMT (HTMT ratio of correlations) ratios below the established level of 0.85. The results suggest that the HTMT ratios demonstrate values that are lower than 0.85, therefore, confirming the presence of discriminant validity.

The adequacy of fit for the study model was additionally assessed by covariance structure analysis conducted in the AMOS programme. The observed model fit metrics for the measurement model, including chi-square minimum discrepancy function (CMIN)/degrees of freedom (DF) = 1.689, incremental fit index (IFI) = 0.977, Tucker–Lewis Index (TLI) = 0.972, root mean square error of approximation (RMSEA) = 0.037, all demonstrate satisfactory values within acceptable ranges. Regarding the structural model, the model fit indices are as follows: CMIN/DF = 1.652, IFI = 0.980, TLI = 0.977, RMSEA = 0.036. The coefficient of determination (R^2) for the variables AAT, CMI and FMP is 42.3%, 11.4% and 25%, respectively.

The notion of direct influence was examined by examining the moderating effect of organisational culture using the PROCESS Macro. The present investigation posited $H1$, $H2$, $H3$, $H4$, $H5$, $H6$, $H7$ and $H8$ which proposed a substantial

Table 1 Demographic details

Demographic measures	Items	Count	%
Gender	Male	342	69
	Female	154	31
Age	Less than 35 years	227	46
	35–44 years	42	8
	45–54 years	22	4
	55 years and more	205	41
Experience	7–10 years	323	65
	11–15 years	132	27
	More than 15 years	41	8

Source: Authors' own work

Table 2 Correlations table

	EXT	ORC	AGR	Correlations COS	OPE	NEU	FMP	CMA	AAT
EXT									
Pearson correlation	1	0.121**	0.101*	0.415**	0.327**	0.386**	0.066	0.109*	0.426**
Sig. (two tailed)		0.007	0.025	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	0.140	0.016	<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
ORC									
Pearson correlation	0.121**	1	0.170**	0.254**	0.274**	0.104*	0.078	0.108*	0.098*
Sig. (two tailed)	0.007		<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	0.020	0.081	0.016	0.028
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
AGR									
Pearson correlation	0.101*	0.170**	1	0.067	0.093*	0.145**	0.144**	0.103*	0.230**
Sig. (two tailed)	0.025	<0.001		0.139	0.038	0.001	0.001	0.021	<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
COS									
Pearson correlation	0.415**	0.254**	0.067	1	0.589**	0.423**	0.023	0.136**	0.466**
Sig. (two tailed)	<0.001	<0.001	0.139		<0.001	<0.001	0.614	0.002	<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
OPE									
Pearson correlation	0.327**	0.274**	0.093*	0.589**	1	0.397**	0.018	0.132**	0.444**
Sig. (two tailed)	<0.001	<0.001	0.038	<0.001		<0.001	0.690	0.003	<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
NEU									
Pearson correlation	0.386**	0.104*	0.145**	0.423**	0.397**	1	0.033	0.110*	0.457**
Sig. (two tailed)	<0.001	0.020	0.001	<0.001	<0.001		0.463	0.014	<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
FMP									
Pearson correlation	0.066	0.078	0.144**	0.023	0.018	0.033	1	0.377**	0.307**
Sig. (two tailed)	0.140	0.081	0.001	0.614	0.690	0.463		<0.001	<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
CMA									
Pearson correlation	0.109*	0.108*	0.103*	0.136**	0.132**	0.110*	0.377**	1	0.307**
Sig. (two tailed)	0.016	0.016	0.021	0.002	0.003	0.014	<0.001		<0.001
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496
AAT									
Pearson correlation	0.426**	0.098*	0.230**	0.466**	0.444**	0.457**	0.307**	0.307**	1
Sig. (two tailed)	<0.001	0.028	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	<0.001	
N	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496	496

Notes: **Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (two tailed); *Correlation is significant at the 0.05 level (two tailed)

Source: Authors' own work

correlation between the independent and dependent variables. Based on the findings shown in Table 6, there is a positive and statistically significant relationship between all the variables. Therefore, the evidence supports *H1* to *H8*.

The present research used the AMOS 28 version, to examine the mediating effect of CMA on the proposed link between AAT and FMP. The findings are shown in Table 7. The results suggest that CMA has a role in partially mediating the relationship between AAT and FMP.

The study used the SPSS PROCESS macro, especially Model 1, to investigate the moderating influence of ORC on the hypothesised relationship between all the associations. The

analysis is reported in Table 8. The findings indicate that ORC does have a moderating effect on the association between AGR and AAT (Figure 3). However, it has been seen that ORC does not have any moderating impact on any of the other relationships. Control variables are crucial in addressing endogeneity issues as they help reduce the impact of omitted variable bias, which is a major contributor to endogeneity (Antonakis et al., 2014). It is important to consider all relevant variables when constructing a model to avoid any misleading relationships between the independent and dependent variables. Failure to do so can result in estimates that are biased and inconsistent. Through the inclusion of control variables, we are able to

Table 3 Key constructs, sources and factor loadings

Factor	Source	Items code	Factor loadings
Extraversion (EXT)	(Costa and McCrae, 2006)	EXT3	0.828
		EXT2	0.717
		EXT1	0.802
Agreeableness (AGR)		AGR3	0.826
		AGR2	0.848
		AGR1	0.888
Conscientiousness (COS)	(Costa and McCrae, 2006; Mahlamäki et al., 2019)	COS4	0.958
		COS3	0.906
		COS2	0.913
		COS1	0.850
Neuroticism (NEU)		NEU3	0.737
		NEU2	0.898
		NEU1	0.833
Openness (OPE)		OPE3	0.892
		OPE2	0.892
		OPE1	0.864
Adoption of AI technologies (AAT)	(Gunasekaran et al., 2017)	AAT3	0.875
		AAT2	0.904
		AAT1	0.937
Competitive advantage (CMA)	(Vorhies and Morgan, 2005)	CMA3	0.661
		CMA2	0.809
		CMA1	0.825
Firm performance (FMP)	(Gunasekaran et al., 2017)	FMP3	0.731
		FMP2	0.702
		FMP1	0.841
Organisational culture (ORC)	(Huey Yiang and Zaman Bin Ahmad, 2009)	ORC3	0.871
		ORC2	0.868
		ORC1	0.832

Source: Authors' own work

address any potential confounding factors, thereby focusing on the impact of the primary independent variable on the dependent variable (Hill et al., 2021). This inclusion is crucial in ensuring that the relationships observed in the model accurately represent genuine associations, without being influenced by hidden factors. Through this approach, control variables play a crucial role in capturing the causal pathways and enhancing the reliability of the model.

In addition, the use of control variables can be beneficial in minimising measurement error and addressing issues of simultaneity, which are common sources of endogeneity. For example, when a variable has an impact on both the independent and dependent variables at the same time, it can result in feedback loops or reciprocal relationships. This can make it difficult to determine the causal direction. By incorporating control variables that consider these shared influences, we can mitigate these concerns and improve the credibility of their results. Control variables play a vital role in addressing endogeneity and enhancing the clarity and reliability of the relationships within the data. By including them, we can obtain more interpretable results. In Table 9, we have shown the control variable results which also signifies that there is no confounding effect of age, gender and experience towards AAT, CMA and FMP.

7. Discussion

The adoption of AI technology can be significantly influenced by many personality factors, such as extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness. These characteristics offer essential insights into the manner in which individuals and organisations engage with and perceive AI-driven solutions across different situations. Extraversion, which is defined by traits such as friendliness and enthusiasm, has the potential to influence the adoption of AI by promoting a greater receptiveness towards AI technologies that facilitate social interactions (H1). For example, persons who exhibit extraverted traits may readily adopt chatbots or virtual assistants that feature conversational interfaces, perceiving them as both engaging and valuable for facilitating communication. In addition, individuals' inclination towards engaging in interpersonal interactions may result in their acceptance and utilisation of AI tools that facilitate cooperation and teamwork. This, in turn, would contribute to the increased integration of such technologies within their professional and social contexts. Conversely, agreeableness (H2), which is associated with characteristics such as cooperativeness and empathy, may influence the adoption of AI by fostering a propensity to use AI for the purpose of increasing customer service and elevating user experiences. Individuals who possess agreeable personality traits are more inclined to endorse AI practises that prioritise ethical issues and cultivate beneficial relationships. Consequently, individuals may exhibit a preference

Table 4 Validity analysis

Variable	CR	AVE	MSV	MR(H)	EXT	ORC	COS	AGR	OPE	NEU	FMP	CMA	AAT
EXT	0.826	0.614	0.236	0.834	0.784								
ORC	0.892	0.734	0.096	0.894	0.149**	0.857							
COS	0.949	0.823	0.381	0.959	0.460***	0.257***	0.907						
AGR	0.890	0.730	0.066	0.894	0.118*	0.189***	0.061	0.854					
OPE	0.914	0.779	0.381	0.915	0.368***	0.309***	0.617***	0.095†	0.883				
NEU	0.864	0.681	0.237	0.884	0.434***	0.104*	0.447***	0.166**	0.429***	0.825			
FMP	0.803	0.578	0.211	0.819	0.070	0.083	0.018	0.177**	0.014	0.030	0.760		
CMA	0.811	0.591	0.211	0.828	0.134*	0.117*	0.143**	0.122*	0.147**	0.142**	0.459***	0.769	
AAT	0.932	0.820	0.237	0.937	0.486***	0.105*	0.487***	0.258***	0.481***	0.487***	0.349***	0.340***	0.906

Notes: *** $p < 0.001$; ** $p < 0.01$; * $p < 0.05$; n.s. = non-significant; MR(H) = MaxR(H)

Source: Authors' own work

Table 5 HTMT analysis

Variable	EXT	ORC	COS	AGR	OPE	NEU	FMP	CMA	AAT
EXT									
ORC	0.122								
COS	0.415	0.254							
AGR	0.100	0.171	0.067						
OPE	0.327	0.274	0.590	0.095					
NEU	0.386	0.104	0.423	0.144	0.397				
FMP	0.066	0.079	0.022	0.144	0.018	0.032			
CMA	0.108	0.108	0.136	0.103	0.133	0.110	0.375		
AAT	0.426	0.098	0.466	0.228	0.444	0.456	0.307	0.307	

Source: Authors' own work

Table 6 Results of hypothesis testing

Path	Estimate	S.E.	C.R.	p-value	Accept/reject	Hypothesis
AAT ← EXT	0.301	0.065	4.621	***	Accept	H2
AAT ← AGR	0.261	0.061	4.248	***	Accept	H1
AAT ← COS	0.198	0.067	2.941	0.003	Accept	H3
AAT ← NEU	0.314	0.077	4.082	***	Accept	H4
AAT ← OPE	0.238	0.065	3.643	***	Accept	H5
CMA ← AAT	0.260	0.040	6.433	***	Accept	H6
FMP ← AAT	0.167	0.041	4.062	***	Accept	H7
FMP ← CMA	0.405	0.063	6.475	***	Accept	H8

Notes: *** $p < 0.001$; n.s. = non-significant

Source: Authors' own work

Table 7 Summary of mediation effects (Mediator-CMA)

Hypothesis	Hypothesised relationship	Direct effect	Indirect effect	Result	Accepted/rejected
H9	AAT → CMA → FMP	0.167***	0.105**	Partial	Accepted

Notes: ** $p < 0.01$; * $p < 0.05$; n.s. = non-significant

Source: Authors' own work

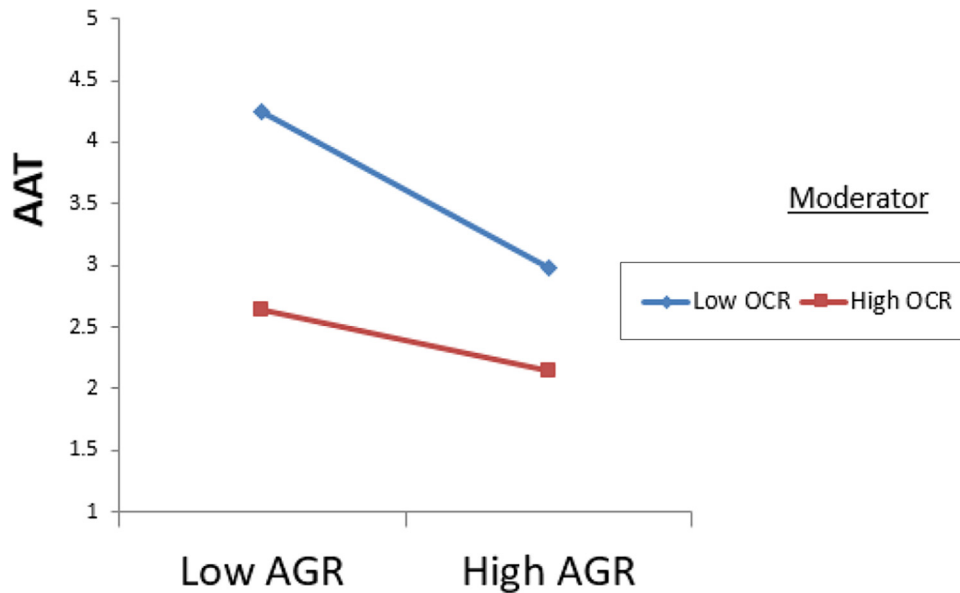
Table 8 Results of moderation analysis

Hypothesis	Path	β	SE	Moderator is ORC		LLCI	ULCI	Moderation?
				t	p-value			
H10a	AAT ← EXT	−0.03	0.06	0.56	0.57	−0.14	0.08	No
H10b	AAT ← AGR	0.19	0.05	4.03	0.00	0.10	0.29	Yes
H10c	AAT ← COS	0.01	0.04	0.23	0.82	−0.07	0.09	No
H10d	AAT ← NEU	−0.03	0.04	−0.74	0.46	−0.12	0.05	No
H10e	AAT ← OPE	−0.13	0.06	−1.98	0.05	−0.25	0.00	No
H10f	CMA ← AAT	0.03	0.05	0.59	0.55	−0.06	0.12	No
H10g	FMP ← AAT	−0.01	0.04	−0.36	0.72	−0.09	0.06	No
H10h	FMP ← CMA	−0.04	0.05	−0.83	0.40	−0.15	0.06	No

Source: Authors' own work

for AI solutions that prioritise the enjoyment of users and the promotion of societal harmony. The adoption of AI technology is significantly influenced by conscientiousness (H3), which is defined by traits such as organisation and discipline. Conscientious persons possess a deep appreciation for the

efficacy and accuracy provided by AI systems. It is probable that they will have a propensity for early adoption of AI technologies that facilitate the optimisation of activities, automation of repetitive procedures and improvement of data management. AI solutions that facilitate project management, data analysis and

Figure 3 Moderating influence of ORC (graphically)

Source: Authors' own work using Excel StatTools

Table 9 Results of control variables

Paths	Estimate	SE	CR	p-value
AAT ← Age	0.045	0.030	1.506	0.132
AAT ← Gender	−0.019	0.091	−0.21	0.834
AAT ← Experience	0.120	0.066	1.806	0.071
CMA ← Age	0.048	0.034	1.391	0.164
CMA ← Gender	−0.001	0.105	−0.01	0.992
CMA ← Experience	0.048	0.077	0.633	0.527
FMP ← Age	−0.006	0.029	−0.202	0.840
FMP ← Gender	−0.039	0.088	−0.447	0.655
FMP ← Experience	0.011	0.064	0.179	0.858

Source: Authors' own work

task tracking are congruent with their inclination towards structured and methodical processes. On the other hand, the presence of neuroticism (*H4*), which is linked to emotional instability and anxiety, may instil a sense of caution in the process of adopting AI. Individuals with elevated levels of neuroticism may demonstrate a propensity for scepticism and reluctance towards AI technologies, particularly when they regard these technologies as potential encroachments on their employment stability or personal privacy. Finally, the inclination towards openness to experience (*H5*), which encompasses a sense of curiosity and a readiness to delve into novel concepts, serves as a catalyst for the widespread acceptance and implementation of AI in various fields and industries. Individuals that possess an open mind-set exhibit a strong enthusiasm towards the advancements in AI and its application in several domains including art, education, entertainment and creative pursuits. Their inclination towards embracing new experiences positions them as early users of AI technology that push the limits and provide innovative viewpoints.

The integration of AI technology has emerged as a pivotal factor in enhancing corporate performance and gaining a competitive edge within the contemporary business environment (*H6*, *H7* and *H8*). AI have the capacity to revolutionise multiple facets of operations, strategy and decision-making, resulting in heightened levels of efficiency, innovation and competitiveness. To begin with, the incorporation of AI technology has the potential to greatly enhance the overall performance of organisations through the optimisation of processes and the augmentation of operational efficiency. The implementation of AI-driven automation has the potential to decrease the amount of manual labour required, mitigate the occurrence of errors and expedite operations that would otherwise consume a significant amount of time. This results in financial advantages and enables staff to concentrate on tasks that generate greater value. Consequently, enterprises that successfully integrate AI into their operations frequently observe enhanced productivity and more efficient allocation of resources, thereby leading to bolstered financial outcomes. Furthermore, AI enables organisations to enhance their competitive position by leveraging data-driven insights and analytics. AI systems have exceptional proficiency in the analysis of extensive data sets, enabling them to identify and extract significant patterns and trends of value. This functionality empowers enterprises to make well-informed decisions, gain deeper insights into client preferences and recognise emerging market prospects. By using predictive analytics powered by AI, organisations can maintain a competitive edge by effectively forecasting market fluctuations and promptly taking proactive measures in response. In addition, the implementation of AI technologies allows companies to improve their client experiences, thereby potentially gaining a substantial competitive edge. Customised recommendations,

conversational agents for customer assistance and product suggestions powered by AI have the potential to enhance customer happiness and foster customer loyalty. Organisations that use AI to deliver a cohesive and personalised consumer experience have the potential to distinguish themselves in the marketplace and establish a more robust presence within their specific sectors.

The moderating function of organisational culture ($H10a,b,c,d,e,f,g,h$) is of considerable importance in determining the extent to which a company can effectively use AI to attain a competitive advantage. Within the realm of AI-driven competitive advantage within companies, there is an interesting connection between organisational culture and agreeableness when it comes to adopting AI technologies. This connection suggests a unique synergy between individual disposition and organisational ethos. Cooperation and interpersonal harmony, when prioritised in organisational cultures, can naturally align with a focus on collaboration and innovation. Within these settings, key account managers who possess a strong inclination towards cooperation may view AI technologies as tools that enhance collaboration and foster stronger relationships, rather than perceiving them as potential risks to their own independence or job stability. Organisational cultures that prioritise collective problem-solving and experimentation create an ideal environment for the integration of AI tools. These cultures foster trust and openness to new methodologies, which in turn accelerates the adoption process, particularly among individuals who are open to new ideas.

On the other hand, the lack of moderating associations between the adoption of AI technologies and personality traits like extraversion, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness might indicate the complex nature of technology adoption in KAM contexts. Although these traits certainly impact individual behaviours and attitudes, their influence may not be as directly influenced by organisational culture when it comes to AI adoption. For example, extraversion may influence a person's inclination for socialising and networking. However, when it comes to adopting technology, personal preferences and perceived usefulness may play a bigger role than organisational norms. Just like a management researcher, it is worth noting that factors such as conscientiousness and openness can impact how individuals respond to change and innovation. However, it is important to recognise that these traits may not solely depend on organisational cultural factors. Thus, the intricate relationship between organisational culture and agreeableness highlights the complex interplay between individual personality traits and organisational dynamics in influencing the adoption of AI technologies. This understanding can guide the development of effective strategies for harnessing AI-driven competitive advantages in the field of KAM.

There may be several factors within the context of AI-driven competitive advantage that contribute to the absence of a moderating association between organisational culture and the adoption of AI technologies, competitive advantage and firm performance by key account managers. First and foremost, it is important to note that organisational culture may not place enough emphasis on integrating and adopting AI technologies. If the organisation's culture does not prioritise innovation, technological advancement or adaptability, key account

managers may not feel encouraged or empowered to explore AI-driven solutions extensively. Without proper emphasis, there is a risk of a disconnect between the organisational culture and the adoption of AI technologies. This can hinder the potential for gaining a competitive advantage and improving performance. Furthermore, in the context of organisational culture promoting innovation and technological adoption, it is worth considering the influence of key account managers' individual personality traits on their approach to AI technologies. Factors such as personal openness to new experiences, proficiency with technology and willingness to take risks can greatly impact how key account managers perceive and use AI tools. If the organisational culture does not acknowledge or adapt to these individual differences, it might face challenges in fully using the potential of AI-driven competitive advantage. Hence, the lack of a moderating link between organisational culture and the adoption of AI technologies, competitive advantage and firm performance by key account managers highlights the significance of taking into account both organisational and individual factors in driving AI integration and success within a company.

8. Theoretical implications

Examining the theoretical implications of the Big-five personality traits of key account managers in relation to the adoption of AI technologies and its subsequent influence on company performance provides significant contributions to the fields of organisational psychology and technology adoption research. To begin with, this study contributes to the existing body of knowledge by enhancing our comprehension of the significance of personality traits in the professional setting. Specifically, it elucidates the impact of traits such as extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness on individuals' attitudes and behaviours towards the adoption of technology within a B2B environment. Furthermore, this study has the potential to enhance the advancement of more inclusive frameworks that incorporate personality features inside known theories of technology adoption. This research attempts to carry forward the discussion on the role of decision makers on technology adoption at the firm level (Thong, 1999). Previous studies have indicated that adoption behaviour is incomplete in absence of such factors as manager's belief, knowledge and characteristics (Riemenschneider *et al.*, 2003; Shiao *et al.*, 2009; Thong, 1999), enthusiasm and growth ambition of the owner (Fillis *et al.*, 2004), top management support and managerial productivity (Grandon and Pearson, 2004).

Also, this study is inline with previous studies which have indicated the possibility of integration of individual-based theory of technology adoption with organisational technology adoption theories (Awa *et al.*, 2015b; Awa and Ojiabo, 2016). A further research on comparison between decision maker-centred approach to organisational technology adoption theories and direct application of individual behaviour models may through up some interesting scenarios. This may also enhance our comprehension of the intricate dynamics between individual variances and organisational procedures. Furthermore, this research can provide clarification on the moderating mechanisms that explain how personality traits

influence decisions regarding the adoption of technology and, subsequently, the performance of an organisation. This comprehensive comprehension can assist organisations in customising their AI implementation methods and team structures to capitalise on the personality characteristics of key account managers in B2B business, so augmenting their competitive edge in the swiftly changing technological environment.

9. Practical implications

The findings of this research have important practical implications for organisations seeking to improve their strategies for adopting AI technology. First and foremost, it is crucial for organisations to acknowledge the impact of personality traits on the adoption of AI technology. By recognising and harnessing the strengths of outgoing team members, organisations can create a welcoming atmosphere for AI tools that enhance social interactions, like chatbots and virtual assistants. Customising AI solutions to match the personality traits of users can encourage higher levels of acceptance and usage. Training programs and workshops that emphasise the advantages of AI in enhancing communication and collaboration can contribute to the wider adoption of these technologies in various professional and social settings.

Second, organisations have the ability to use this intelligence to make more informed decisions pertaining to the composition of their teams. For example, organisations have the ability to selectively allocate key account managers who possess personality attributes that are congruent with the unique requirements of AI adoption endeavours. Individuals with extraverted personality traits may demonstrate exceptional performance in positions that require interaction with customers using AI tools. On the other hand, conscientious personnel may exhibit high levels of success in project management roles, where they may effectively oversee the seamless integration of AI technologies.

Third, the impact of personality traits on AI adoption is significantly influenced by the organisational culture. It is crucial for companies to foster a culture that prioritises cooperation, innovation and adaptability. By placing a strong emphasis on these values, organisations can establish a conducive atmosphere that encourages individuals with agreeable traits to readily embrace AI technologies, thereby improving customer service and enhancing user experiences. Promoting collective problem-solving and experimentation can help foster the adoption of AI tools, especially among individuals who are inclined towards embracing new concepts. To accomplish this, it is crucial for leadership to actively encourage and back cultural initiatives that are in line with these values. This will help create an organisational environment that is conducive to the integration of AI.

Fourth, organisations have the opportunity to incorporate continuous assessments and feedback mechanisms to get insights into the potential transformation of key account managers' personality qualities. It has been found that AI technologies become increasingly integrated into their responsibilities. This information can be used to inform the creation of personalised growth plans and strategies aimed at

optimising the synergy between individual features and the adoption of technology.

Finally, organisations must take into account both organisational and individual factors when formulating AI adoption strategies. Recognising the significance of cultivating an environment that encourages innovation, it is also essential to consider the unique personality traits and technological skills of key account managers. Providing tailored assistance and resources, such as specialised training sessions and technological support, can effectively address the disconnect between an organisation's culture and an individual's preparedness for adopting AI. Through a comprehensive approach that considers cultural, individual and technological factors, organisations can better leverage AI-driven competitive advantages, resulting in enhanced firm performance and long-term market dominance.

10. Limitations and future research directions

The present investigation is subject to several limitations. Initially, data was gathered from key account managers used inside the Indian automotive sector. Hence, the conclusions derived from this study lack generalizability to other industries, including health care, manufacturing, power generation, hospitality, etc. (Al-Muftah *et al.*, 2018; Chatterjee *et al.*, 2022). There exists potential for the replication of this study in several sectors and nations, which might potentially yield valuable insights. Furthermore, the research used a cross-sectional research method (quantitative data analysis) to gather data at a single time point. The dynamic nature of the AI presents an opportunity for major insights into the automobile sector through the utilisation of a longitudinal study strategy. Furthermore, we used organisational culture as a moderating factor. Subsequent research endeavours may incorporate a range of variables, including environmental influences, legislative changes and organisational competencies, to comprehensively investigate the phenomenon from diverse viewpoints. To get deeper insights into the phenomenon, future research endeavours may consider integrating the TOE framework, innovation resistance theory, task-technology fit theory and diffusion of innovation theory inside a cohesive model. To enhance the scope of inquiry and facilitate a more comprehensive comprehension of the phenomena, it is recommended that next investigations incorporate a multi-method design. This approach would offer improved prospects for subsequent research endeavours and the development of novel conceptual frameworks. In addition, the focus on key account managers may present a limitation; therefore, in future research, we could include other types of managers, such as Sales managers, Product managers and Marketing managers, to gain a more comprehensive perspective. Another limitation of the study is there are no constructs which talks about capabilities and knowledge. Further investigation can be used to examine the impact of an organisation's current AI capabilities, such as their data infrastructure and technical expertise, as well as their understanding of AI's potential applications, on the adoption of AI in KAM. Understanding an organisation's specific strengths and weaknesses can offer valuable insights for customising AI adoption strategies.

11. Conclusions

In summary, the relationship between the adoption of AI technologies and business performance, as influenced by the Big-five personality traits of senior account managers, is complex and subject to several factors. Gaining insight into the intersection of personality qualities, such as extraversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, neuroticism and openness, and the adoption of AI provides organisations with useful knowledge for enhancing their approaches to integrating technology. Organisations can optimise the capabilities of AI technologies by carefully assigning personnel with appropriate attributes to positions and responsibilities associated with AI adoption. In addition, the customisation of training and development programmes to optimise the strengths of important account managers, as determined by their personality profiles, can effectively augment their proficiency and flexibility within the dynamic and swiftly changing technological environment. In essence, acknowledging the influence of personality traits on the adoption of AI not only enhances the efficacy of technology integration but also enables organisations to gain a competitive edge and cultivate more robust client connections. The integration of personality and technology in a comprehensive manner enables organisations to flourish within a commercial climate that is heavily influenced by AI.

References

- Albarracin, D., Johnson, B.T., Zanna, M.P. and Kumkale, G.T. (2005), "Attitudes: introduction and scope", *The Handbook of Attitudes*, Vol. 2005, pp. 3-19.
- Al-Muftah, H., Weerakkody, V., Rana, N.P., Sivarajah, U. and Irani, Z. (2018), "Factors influencing e-diplomacy implementation: exploring causal relationships using interpretive structural modelling", *Government Information Quarterly*, Vol. 35 No. 3, pp. 502-514.
- AlSheibani, S., Cheung, Y. and Messom, C. (2020), "Re-thinking the competitive landscape of artificial intelligence", Proceedings of the Annual HI International Conference on System Sciences, IEEE Computer Society, pp. 5861-5870.
- Anaza, N.A. and Nowlin, E.L. (2017), "What's mine is mine: a study of salesperson knowledge withholding & hoarding behavior", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 64, pp. 14-24.
- Antonakis, J., Bendahan, S., Jacquart, P. and Lalive, R. (2014), "Causality and endogeneity: problems and solutions", *The Oxford Handbook of Leadership and Organizations*, Vol. 1 No. 6, pp. 93-117.
- Ashton, M.C., Lee, K. and Paunonen, S.V. (2002), "What is the Central feature of extraversion? Social attention versus reward sensitivity", *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, Vol. 83 No. 1, pp. 245-252.
- Awa, H.O. and Ojiabo, O.U. (2016), "A model of adoption determinants of ERP within T-O-E framework", *Information Technology & People*, Vol. 29 No. 4, pp. 901-930.
- Awa, H.O., Baridam, D.M. and Nwibere, B.M. (2015a), "Demographic determinants of electronic commerce (EC) adoption by SMEs: a twist by location factors", *Journal of Enterprise Information Management*, Vol. 28 No. 3, pp. 326-345.
- Awa, H.O., Ojiabo, O.U. and Emecheta, B.C. (2015b), "Integrating TAM, TPB and TOE frameworks and expanding their characteristic constructs for e-commerce adoption by SMEs", *Journal of Science & Technology Policy Management*, Vol. 6 No. 1, pp. 76-94.
- Awa, H.O., Ojiabo, O.U. and Orokor, L.E. (2017), "Integrated technology-organization-environment (T-O-E) taxonomies for technology adoption", *Journal of Enterprise Information Management*, Vol. 30 No. 6, pp. 893-921.
- Badawi, N.S., Battor, M. and Badghish, S. (2022), "Relational key account management: insights from the middle eastern context", *Journal of Business & Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 37 No. 2, pp. 353-365.
- Barnett, T., Pearson, A.W., Pearson, R. and Kellermanns, F. W. (2015), "Five-factor model personality traits as predictors of perceived and actual usage of technology", *European Journal of Information Systems*, Vol. 24 No. 4, pp. 374-390.
- Barney, J. (1991), "Firm resources and sustained competitive advantage", *Journal of Management*, Vol. 17 No. 1, pp. 99-120.
- Berings, D., De Fruyt, F. and Bouwen, R. (2004), "Work values and personality traits as predictors of enterprising and social vocational interests", *Personality and Individual Differences*, Vol. 36 No. 2, pp. 349-364.
- Berthon, P., Pitt, L.F. and Ewing, M.T. (2001), "Corollaries of the collective: the influence of organizational culture and memory development on perceived decision-making context", *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, Vol. 29 No. 2, pp. 135-150.
- Bhat, U.M., Bapat, D. and Mookerjee, A. (2022), "Impact of personality factors on purchase and adoption of consumer durables with advanced technology", *Journal of Indian Business Research*, Vol. 14 No. 3, pp. 251-277.
- Božič, K. and Dimovski, V. (2019), "Business intelligence and analytics for value creation: the role of absorptive capacity", *International Journal of Information Management*, Vol. 46, pp. 93-103.
- Brinkmann, S. (2013), *Qualitative Interviewing*, Oxford University Press, Oxford.
- Caligiuri, P.M. (2000), "The big five personality characteristics as predictors of expatriate's desire to terminate the assignment and supervisor-rated performance", *Personnel Psychology*, Vol. 53 No. 1, pp. 67-88.
- Cameron, K.S. and Quinn, R. (2011), *Diagnosing and Changing Organizational Culture: Based on Competing Values Framework*, 3rd ed. Jossey-Bass, San Francisco, CA.
- Campbell, A.J. (2003), "Creating customer knowledge competence: managing customer relationship management programs strategically", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 32 No. 5, pp. 375-383.
- Cao, G., Duan, Y., Edwards, J.S. and Dwivedi, Y.K. (2021), "Understanding managers' attitudes and behavioral intentions towards using artificial intelligence for organizational decision-making", *Technovation*, Vol. 106, p. 102312.
- Castro, F.G., Barrera M. Jr. and Holleran Steiker, L.K. (2010), "Issues and challenges in the design of culturally adapted

- evidence-based interventions”, *Annual Review of Clinical Psychology*, Vol. 6 No. 1, pp. 213–239.
- Chatterjee, D., Grewal, R. and Sambamurthy, V. (2002), “Shaping up for e-commerce: institutional enablers of the organizational assimilation of web technologies”, *MIS Quarterly*, Vol. 26 No. 2, pp. 65–89.
- Chatterjee, S., Rana, N.P. and Dwivedi, Y.K. (2022), “Assessing consumers’ co-production and future participation on value co-creation and business benefit: an FPCB model perspective”, *Information Systems Frontiers*, Vol. 24 No. 3, pp. 945–964.
- Chatterjee, S., Rana, N.P., Dwivedi, Y.K. and Baabdullah, A. M. (2021), “Understanding AI adoption in manufacturing and production firms using an integrated TAM-TOE model”, *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, Vol. 170, p. 120880.
- Chen, L., Jiang, M., Jia, F. and Liu, G. (2022), “Artificial intelligence adoption in business-to-business marketing: toward a conceptual framework”, *Journal of Business & Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 37 No. 5, pp. 1025–1044.
- Chittipaka, V., Kumar, S., Sivarajah, U., Bowden, J.L.H. and Baral, M.M. (2022), “Blockchain technology for supply chains operating in emerging markets: an empirical examination of technology-organization-environment (TOE) framework”, *Annals of Operations Research*, Vol. 327 No. 1, pp. 465–492.
- Costa, P. and McCrae, R. (2006), *Revised NEO Personality Inventory (NEO PI-R) Manual*, Hogrefe, Oxford.
- Dasgupta, S. and Gupta, B. (2019), “Espoused organizational culture values as antecedents of internet technology adoption in an emerging economy”, *Information & Management*, Vol. 56 No. 6, p. 103142.
- Davies, I.A. and Ryals, L.J. (2013), “Attitudes and behaviours of key account managers: are they really any different to senior sales professionals?”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 42 No. 6, pp. 919–931.
- Dubey, R., Gunasekaran, A., Childe, S.J., Bryde, D.J., Giannakis, M., Foropon, C., Roubaud, D., et al. (2020), “Big data analytics and artificial intelligence pathway to operational performance under the effects of entrepreneurial orientation and environmental dynamism: a study of manufacturing organisations”, *International Journal of Production Economics*, Vol. 226, p. 107599.
- Dwivedi, Y.K., Ismagilova, E., Rana, N.P. and Raman, R. (2023), “Social media adoption, usage and impact in business-to-business (B2B) context: a state-of-the-art literature review”, *Information Systems Frontiers*, Vol. 25 No. 3, pp. 971–993.
- Eagly, A.H. and Chaiken, S. (2007), “The advantages of an inclusive definition of attitude”, *Social Cognition*, Vol. 25 No. 5, pp. 582–602.
- El-Kassar, A.N. and Singh, S.K. (2019), “Green innovation and organizational performance: the influence of big data and the moderating role of management commitment and HR practices”, *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, Vol. 144, pp. 483–498.
- Ellis, N. and Iwasaki, A. (2018), “Making sense of global key account management (GAM): a case study from Japan”, *Journal of Business and Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 33 No. 7, pp. 1052–1064.
- Fereday, J. and Muir-Cochrane, E. (2006), “Demonstrating rigor using thematic analysis: a hybrid approach of inductive and deductive coding and theme development”, *International Journal of Qualitative Methods*, Vol. 5 No. 1, pp. 80–92.
- Fillis, I., Wagner, B. and Johansson, U. (2004), “A qualitative investigation of smaller firm e-business development”, *Journal of Small Business and Enterprise Development*, Vol. 11 No. 3, pp. 349–361.
- Field, A. (2013), *Discovering Statistics Using IBM SPSS Statistics: And Sex and Drugs and Rock “N” Roll*, 4th ed., Sage, Los Angeles, London, New Delhi.
- Finnegan, S., Bruce, J. and Seers, K. (2019), “What enables older people to continue with their falls prevention exercises? A qualitative systematic review”, *BMJ Open*, Vol. 9 No. 4, p. e026074.
- Fornell, C. and Larcker, D.F. (1981), “Evaluating structural equation models with unobservable variables and measurement error”, *Journal of Marketing Research*, Vol. 18, No. 1, pp. 39–50.
- Fossey, E., Harvey, C., McDermott, F. and Davidson, L. (2002), “Understanding and evaluating qualitative research”, *Australian & New Zealand Journal of Psychiatry*, Vol. 36 No. 6, pp. 717–732.
- Gardner, W.L., Reithel, B.J., Coglisier, C.C., Walumbwa, F.O. and Foley, R.T. (2012), “Matching personality and organizational culture”, *Management Communication Quarterly*, Vol. 26 No. 4, pp. 585–622.
- Gaudiello, I., Zibetti, E., Lefort, S., Chetouani, M. and Ivaldi, S. (2016), “Trust as indicator of robot functional and social acceptance. An experimental study on user conformation to iCub answers”, *Computers in Human Behavior*, Vol. 61, pp. 633–655.
- Georges, L. and Eggert, A. (2003), “Key account managers’ role within the value creation process of collaborative relationships”, *Journal of Business-to-Business Marketing*, Vol. 10 No. 4, pp. 1–22.
- Grandon, E.E. and Pearson, J.M. (2004), “Electronic commerce adoption: an empirical study of small and medium US businesses”, *Information & Management*, Vol. 42 No. 1, pp. 197–216.
- Grant, R.M. (1996), “Toward a knowledge-based theory of the firm”, *Strategic Management Journal*, Vol. 17 No. S2, pp. 109–122.
- Gray, J.A. (1973), “Causal theories of personality and how to test them”, *Multivariate Analysis and Psychological Theory*, Vol. 16, pp. 302–354.
- Guenzi, P. and Storbacka, K. (2015), “The organizational implications of implementing key account management: a case-based examination”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 45, pp. 84–97.
- Guenzi, P., Pardo, C. and Georges, L. (2007), “Relational selling strategy and key account managers’ relational behaviors: an exploratory study”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 36 No. 1, pp. 121–133.
- Gunasekaran, A., Papadopoulos, T., Dubey, R., Wamba, S.F., Childe, S.J., Hazen, B. and Akter, S. (2017), “Big data and predictive analytics for supply chain and organizational

- performance”, *Journal of Business Research*, Vol. 70, pp. 308–317.
- Guesalaga, R., Gabrielsson, M., Rogers, B., Ryals, L. and Marcos Cuevas, J. (2018), “Which resources and capabilities underpin strategic key account management?”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 75, pp. 160–172.
- Haenlein, M. and Kaplan, A. (2019), “A brief history of artificial intelligence: on the past, present, and future of artificial intelligence”, *California Management Review*, Vol. 61 No. 4, pp. 5–14.
- Hakanen, T. (2014), “Co-creating integrated solutions within business networks: the KAM team as knowledge integrator”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 43 No. 7, pp. 1195–1203.
- Henriksen, H.Z. (2006), “Motivators for IOS adoption in Denmark”, *Journal of Electronic Commerce in Organizations*, Vol. 4 No. 2, pp. 25–39.
- Herhausen, D., Ivens, B., Spencer, R. and Weibel, M. (2022), “Key account management configurations and their effectiveness: a quasi-replication and extension”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 101, pp. 98–112.
- Herhausen, D., Miočević, D., Morgan, R.E. and Kleijnen, M.H.P. (2020), “The digital marketing capabilities gap”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 90, pp. 276–290.
- Hill, A.D., Johnson, S.G., Greco, L.M., O’Boyle, E.H. and Walter, S.L. (2021), “Endogeneity: a review and agenda for the methodology-practice divide affecting micro and macro research”, *Journal of Management*, Vol. 47 No. 1, pp. 105–143.
- Homburg, C., Workman, J.P. and Jensen, O. (2002), “A configurational perspective on key account management”, *Journal of Marketing*, Vol. 66 No. 2, pp. 38–60.
- Hossain, M.A., Akter, S. and Yanamandram, V. (2020), “Revisiting customer analytics capability for data-driven retailing”, *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, Vol. 56, p. 102187.
- Huey Yiing, L. and Zaman Bin Ahmad, K. (2009), “The moderating effects of organizational culture on the relationships between leadership behaviour and organizational commitment and between organizational commitment and job satisfaction and performance”, *Leadership and Organization Development Journal*, Vol. 30 No. 1, pp. 53–86.
- Ivens, B.S. and Pardo, C. (2007), “Are key account relationships different? Empirical results on supplier strategies and customer reactions”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 36 No. 4, pp. 470–482.
- Ivens, B.S., Pardo, C., Niersbach, B. and Leischnig, A. (2016), “Firm-internal key account management networks: framework, case study, avenues for future research”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 58, pp. 102–113.
- Jeyaraj, A., Rottman, J.W. and Lacity, M.C. (2006), “A review of the predictors, linkages, and biases in IT innovation adoption research”, *Journal of Information Technology*, Vol. 21 No. 1, pp. 1–23.
- Johnson, J.S. and Sohi, R.S. (2017), “Getting business-to-business salespeople to implement strategies associated with introducing new products and services”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 62, pp. 137–149.
- Jones, E., Dixon, A.L., Chonko, L.B. and Cannon, J.P. (2005), “Key accounts and team selling: a review, framework, and research agenda?”, *Journal of Personal Selling and Sales Management*, Vol. 25 No. 2, p. 181.
- Judge, T.A. and Cable, D.M. (1997), “Applicant personality, organizational culture, and organization attraction”, *Personnel Psychology*, Vol. 50 No. 2, pp. 359–394.
- Judge, T.A. and Zapata, C.P. (2015), “The person–situation debate revisited: effect of situation strength and trait activation on the validity of the big five personality traits in predicting job performance”, *Academy of Management Journal*, Vol. 58 No. 4, pp. 1149–1179.
- Kaplan, A. and Haenlein, M. (2019), “Siri, Siri, in my hand: who’s the fairest in the land? On the interpretations, illustrations, and implications of artificial intelligence”, *Business Horizons*, Vol. 62 No. 1, pp. 15–25.
- Kauffman, R.J. and Walden, E.A. (2001), “Economics and electronic commerce: survey and directions for research”, *International Journal of Electronic Commerce*, Vol. 5 No. 4, pp. 5–116.
- Keegan, B.J., Canhoto, A.I. and Yen, D.A.W. (2022), “Power negotiation on the tango dancefloor: the adoption of AI in B2B marketing”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 100, pp. 36–48.
- Keegan, B.J., Dennehy, D. and Naudé, P. (2024), “Implementing artificial intelligence in traditional B2B marketing practices: an activity theory perspective”, *Information Systems Frontiers*, Vol. 26 No. 3, pp. 1025–1039.
- Kenrick, D.T. and Funder, D.C. (1988), “Profiting from controversy: lessons from the Person-Situation debate”, *American Psychologist*, Vol. 43 No. 1, pp. 23–34.
- Kiyabo, K. and Isaga, N. (2020), “Entrepreneurial orientation, competitive advantage, and SMEs’ performance: application of firm growth and personal wealth measures”, *Journal of Innovation and Entrepreneurship*, Vol. 9 No. 1, pp. 1–15.
- Kleinaltenkamp, M., Eggert, A., Kashyap, V. and Ulaga, W. (2022), “Rethinking customer-perceived value in business markets from an organizational perspective”, *Journal of Inter-Organizational Relationships*, Vol. 28 Nos 1/2, pp. 1–18.
- Knobloch, F. and Mercure, J.F. (2016), “The behavioural aspect of green technology investments: a general positive model in the context of heterogeneous agents”, *Environmental Innovation and Societal Transitions*, Vol. 21, pp. 39–55.
- Kortum, P. and Oswald, F.L. (2018), “The impact of personality on the subjective assessment of usability”, *International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction*, Vol. 34 No. 2, pp. 177–186.
- Kuan, K.K.Y. and Chau, P.Y.K. (2001), “A perception-based model for EDI adoption in small businesses using a technology–organization–environment framework”, *Information & Management*, Vol. 38 No. 8, pp. 507–521.
- Kumar, A. and Shankar, A. (2024), “Building a sustainable future with enterprise metaverse in a data-driven era: a

- technology-organization-environment (TOE) perspective”, *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, Vol. 81, p. 103986.
- Kumar, P., Sharma, A. and Salo, J. (2019), “A bibliometric analysis of extended key account management literature”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 82, pp. 276–292.
- Lai, C.J. and Yang, Y. (2017), “The role of formal information sharing in key account team effectiveness: does informal control matter and when?”, *Journal of Personal Selling & Sales Management*, Vol. 37 No. 4, pp. 313–331.
- Lane, W. and Manner, C. (2011), “The impact of personality traits on smartphone ownership and use”, *International Journal of Business and Social Science*, Vol. 2 No. 17, available at: www.ijbssnet.com
- Larson, E.W. and Gobeli, D.H. (1988), “Organizing for product development projects”, *Journal of Product Innovation Management*, Vol. 5 No. 3, pp. 180–190.
- Latinovic, Z. and Chatterjee, S.C. (2022), “Achieving the promise of AI and ML in delivering economic and relational customer value in B2B”, *Journal of Business Research*, Vol. 144, pp. 966–974.
- Leischnig, A., Ivens, B.S., Niersbach, B. and Pardo, C. (2018), “Mind the gap: a process model for diagnosing barriers to key account management implementation”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 70, pp. 58–67.
- Liu, X. (2020), “Analyzing the impact of user-generated content on B2B firms’ stock performance: big data analysis with machine learning methods”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 86, pp. 30–39.
- Liu, H., Ke, W., Wei, K.K., Gu, J. and Chen, H. (2010), “The role of institutional pressures and organizational culture in the firm’s intention to adopt internet-enabled supply chain management systems”, *Journal of Operations Management*, Vol. 28 No. 5, pp. 372–384.
- Low, C., Chen, Y. and Wu, M. (2011), “Understanding the determinants of cloud computing adoption”, *Industrial Management & Data Systems*, Vol. 111 No. 7, pp. 1006–1023.
- McCarthy Byrne, T.M., Moon, M.A. and Mentzer, J.T. (2011), “Motivating the industrial sales force in the sales forecasting process”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 40 No. 1, pp. 128–138.
- Mahlamäki, T., Rintamäki, T. and Rajah, E. (2019), “The role of personality and motivation on key account manager job performance”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 83, pp. 174–184.
- Makkonen, H., Johnston, W.J. and Javalgi, R.R.G. (2016), “A behavioral approach to organizational innovation adoption”, *Journal of Business Research*, Vol. 69 No. 7, pp. 2480–2489.
- Marangunić, N. and Granić, A. (2015), “Technology acceptance model: a literature review from 1986 to 2013”, *Universal Access in the Information Society*, Vol. 14 No. 1, pp. 81–95.
- Martínez-López, F.J. and Casillas, J. (2013), “Artificial intelligence-based systems applied in industrial marketing: an historical overview, current and future insights”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 42 No. 4, pp. 489–495.
- Medisaukaite, A., Alexander, K., Rich, A., Knight, L., Adesalu, O. and Silkens, M.E.W.M. (2023), “To stay or go? A mixed methods study of psychiatry trainees’ intentions to leave training”, *Journal of Workplace Behavioral Health*, Vol. 39 No. 1, pp. 1–19.
- Melitski, J., Gavin, D. and Gavin, J. (2010), “Technology adoption and organizational culture in public organizations”, *International Journal of Organization Theory & Behavior*, Vol. 13 No. 4, pp. 546–568.
- Melville, N. and Ramirez, R. (2008), “Information technology innovation diffusion: an information requirements paradigm”, *Information Systems Journal*, Vol. 18 No. 3, pp. 247–273.
- Mishra, S., Ewing, M.T. and Cooper, H.B. (2022), “Artificial intelligence focus and firm performance”, *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, Vol. 50 No. 6, pp. 1176–1197.
- Mohtaramzadeh, M., Ramayah, T. and Jun-Hwa, C. (2018), “B2B E-Commerce adoption in Iranian manufacturing companies: analyzing the moderating role of organizational culture”, *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*, Vol. 34 No. 7, pp. 621–639.
- Moradi, M. and Dass, M. (2022), “Applications of artificial intelligence in B2B marketing: challenges and future directions”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 107, pp. 300–314.
- Moskowitz, D.S. (1994), “Cross-Situational generality and the interpersonal circumplex”, *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, Vol. 66 No. 5, pp. 921–933.
- Murphy, L.E. and Coughlan, J.P. (2018), “Does it pay to be proactive? Testing proactiveness and the joint effect of internal and external collaboration on key account manager performance”, *Journal of Personal Selling & Sales Management*, Vol. 38 No. 2, pp. 205–219.
- Nätti, S., Halinen, A. and Hanttu, N. (2006), “Customer knowledge transfer and key account management in professional service organizations”, *International Journal of Service Industry Management*, Vol. 17 No. 4, pp. 304–319.
- Neumann, O., Guirguis, K. and Steiner, R. (2024), “Exploring artificial intelligence adoption in public organizations: a comparative case study”, *Public Management Review*, Vol. 26 No. 1, pp. 114–141.
- O’Reilly, C.A., Caldwell, D.F., Chatman, J.A. and Doerr, B. (2014), “Promise and problems of organizational culture: CEO personality, culture, and firm performance”, *Group & Organization Management*, Vol. 39 No. 6, pp. 595–625.
- Occhipinti, C., Carnevale, A., Briguglio, L., Iannone, A. and Bisconti, P. (2023), “SAT: a methodology to assess the social acceptance of innovative AI-based technologies”, *Journal of Information, Communication and Ethics in Society*, Vol. 21 No. 1, pp. 94–111.
- Oh, I.S., Kim, S. and Van Iddekinge, C.H. (2015), “Taking it to another level: do personality-based human capital resources matter to firm performance?”, *Journal of Applied Psychology*, Vol. 100 No. 3, pp. 935–947.
- Oliveira, T. and Martins, M.F. (2010), “Understanding e-business adoption across industries in European

- countries”, *Industrial Management & Data Systems*, Vol. 110 No. 9, pp. 1337-1354.
- Parasuraman, R., Molloy, R. and Singh, I.L. (1993), “Performance consequences of Automation-Induced ‘complacency’”, *The International Journal of Aviation Psychology*, Vol. 3 No. 1, pp. 1-23.
- Pardo, C., Ivens, B.S. and Niersbach, B. (2020), “An identity perspective of key account managers as paradoxical relationship managers”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 89, pp. 355-372.
- Pardo, C., Ivens, B.S. and Wilson, K. (2014), “Differentiation and alignment in KAM implementation”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 43 No. 7, pp. 1136-1145.
- Pardo, C., Henneberg, S.C., Mouzas, S. and Naudé, P. (2006), “Unpicking the meaning of value in key account management”, *European Journal of Marketing*, Vol. 40 Nos 11/12, pp. 1360-1374.
- Paschen, J., Kietzmann, J. and Kietzmann, T.C. (2019), “Artificial intelligence (AI) and its implications for market knowledge in B2B marketing”, *Journal of Business & Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 34 No. 7, pp. 1410-1419.
- Penrose, E.T. (1959), *The Theory of the Growth of the Firm*, Wiley, New York, NY.
- Pereira, G., Tzempelikos, N., Trento, L.R., Trento, C.R., Borchardt, M. and Viegas, C.V. (2019), “Top managers’ role in key account management”, *Journal of Business and Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 34, No. 5, pp. 977-993.
- Qu, W., Sun, H. and Ge, Y. (2021), “The effects of trait anxiety and the big five personality traits on self-driving car acceptance”, *Transportation*, Vol. 48 No. 5, pp. 2663-2679.
- Rahman, M.S., Bag, S., Gupta, S. and Sivarajah, U. (2023), “Technology readiness of B2B firms and AI-based customer relationship management capability for enhancing social sustainability performance”, *Journal of Business Research*, Vol. 156, p. 113525.
- Rao Kowtha, N. and Choon, W.T. (2001), “Determinants of website development: a study of electronic commerce in Singapore”, *Information & Management*, Vol. 39 No. 3, pp. 227-242.
- Riedl, R. (2022), “Is trust in artificial intelligence systems related to user personality? Review of empirical evidence and future research directions”, *Electronic Markets*, Vol. 32 No. 4, pp. 2021-2051.
- Riemenschneider, C.K., Harrison, D.A. and Mykytyn, P.P. (2003), “Understanding it adoption decisions in small business: integrating current theories”, *Information & Management*, Vol. 40 No. 4, pp. 269-285.
- Rivard, S., Raymond, L. and Verreault, D. (2006), “Resource-based view and competitive strategy: an integrated model of the contribution of information technology to firm performance”, *The Journal of Strategic Information Systems*, Vol. 15 No. 1, pp. 29-50.
- Roberts, R., Flin, R., Millar, D. and Corradi, L. (2021), “Psychological factors influencing technology adoption: a case study from the oil and gas industry”, *Technovation*, Vol. 102, p. 102219.
- Ryals, L.J. and Davies, I.A. (2013), “Where’s the strategic intent in key account relationships?”, *Journal of Business and Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 28 No. 2, pp. 111-124.
- Sabherwal, R., Jeyaraj, A. and Chowa, C. (2006), “Information system success: individual and organizational determinants”, *Management Science*, Vol. 52 No. 12, pp. 1849-1864.
- Saksvik, I.B. and Hetland, H. (2011), “The role of personality in stress perception across different vocational types”, *Journal of Employment Counseling*, Vol. 48 No. 1, pp. 3-16.
- Salojärvi, H. and Saarenketo, S. (2013), “The effect of teams on customer knowledge processing, esprit de corps and account performance in international key account management”, *European Journal of Marketing*, Vol. 47 Nos 5/6, pp. 987-1005.
- Salojärvi, H. and Sainio, L.M. (2010), “Customer knowledge processing and key account performance”, *European Business Review*, Vol. 22 No. 3, pp. 339-352.
- Salojärvi, H., Sainio, L.M. and Tarkiainen, A. (2010), “Organizational factors enhancing customer knowledge utilization in the management of key account relationships”, *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 39 No. 8, pp. 1395-1402.
- Salwani, M.I., Marthandan, G., Norzaidi, M.D. and Chong, S. C. (2009), “E-commerce usage and business performance in the Malaysian tourism sector: empirical analysis”, *Information Management & Computer Security*, Vol. 17 No. 2, pp. 166-185.
- Sandesh, S.P., Sreejesh, S. and Paul, J. (2023), “Key account management in B2B marketing: a systematic literature review and research agenda”, *Journal of Business Research*, Vol. 156, p. 113541.
- Santamaria, T. and Nathan-Roberts, D. (2017), ““Personality measurement and design in human-robot interaction: a systematic and critical review”, *Proceedings of the Human Factors and Ergonomics Society, Human Factors and Ergonomics Society Inc*, pp. 853-857.
- Schepman, A. and Rodway, P. (2023), “The general attitudes towards artificial intelligence scale (GAAIS): confirmatory validation and associations with personality, corporate distrust, and general trust”, *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*, Vol. 39 No. 13, pp. 2724-2741.
- Sengupta, S., Krapfel, R.E. and Pusateri, M.A. (2000), “An empirical investigation of key account salesperson effectiveness”, *Journal of Personal Selling and Sales Management*, Vol. 20 No. 4, pp. 253-261.
- Shalender, K. and Yadav, R.K. (2019), “Strategic flexibility, manager personality, and firm performance: the case of Indian automobile industry”, *Global Journal of Flexible Systems Management*, Vol. 20 No. 1, pp. 77-90.
- Shank, D.B., Graves, C., Gott, A., Gamez, P. and Rodriguez, S. (2019), “Feeling our way to machine minds: people’s emotions when perceiving mind in artificial intelligence”, *Computers in Human Behavior*, Vol. 98, pp. 256-266.
- Sharma, A. (2006), “Success factors in key accounts”, *Journal of Business & Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 21 No. 3, pp. 141-150.
- Sheth, J.N. and Parvatiyar, A. (1995), “The evolution of relationship marketing”, *International Business Review*, Vol. 4 No. 4, pp. 397-418.

- Shiau, W.L., Hsu, P.Y. and Wang, J.Z. (2009), "Development of measures to assess the ERP adoption of small and medium enterprises", *Journal of Enterprise Information Management*, Vol. 22 Nos 1/2, pp. 99–118.
- Shropshire, J., Warkentin, M. and Sharma, S. (2015), "Personality, attitudes, and intentions: predicting initial adoption of information security behavior", *Computers & Security*, Vol. 49, pp. 177–191.
- Singh, J., Flaherty, K., Sohi, R.S., Deeter-Schmelz, D., Habel, J., Le Meunier-FitzHugh, K., Malshe, A., et al. (2019), "Sales profession and professionals in the age of digitization and artificial intelligence technologies: concepts, priorities, and questions", *Journal of Personal Selling & Sales Management*, Vol. 39 No. 1, pp. 2–22.
- Speakman, J.I. and Ryals, L. (2012), "Key account management: the inside selling job", *Journal of Business and Industrial Marketing*, Vol. 27, No. 5, pp. 360–369.
- Sok, K.M., Sok, P. and De Luca, L.M. (2016), "The effect of 'can do' and 'reason to' motivations on service-sales ambidexterity", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 55, pp. 144–155.
- Sponder, J.C. and Grant, R.M. (1996), "Knowledge and the firm: overview", *Strategic Management Journal*, Vol. 17 No. S2, pp. 5–9.
- Stein, J.P., Liebold, B. and Ohler, P. (2019), "Stay back, clever thing! Linking situational control and human uniqueness concerns to the aversion against autonomous technology", *Computers in Human Behavior*, Vol. 95, pp. 73–82.
- Syam, N. and Sharma, A. (2018), "Waiting for a sales renaissance in the fourth industrial revolution: machine learning and artificial intelligence in sales research and practice", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 69, pp. 135–146.
- Thong, J.Y.L. (1999), "An integrated model of information systems adoption in small businesses", *Journal of Management Information Systems*, Vol. 15 No. 4, pp. 187–214.
- Tornatzky, L. and Fleischer, M. (1990), *The Process of Technology Innovation*, Lexington Books, Lexington, MA.
- Tuncdogan, A., Van Den Bosch, F. and Volberda, H. (2015), "Regulatory focus as a psychological micro-foundation of leaders' exploration and exploitation activities", *The Leadership Quarterly*, Vol. 26 No. 5, pp. 838–850.
- Tzempelikos, N. and Gounaris, S. (2013), "Approaching key account management from a long-term perspective", *Journal of Strategic Marketing*, Vol. 21 No. 2, pp. 179–198.
- Tzempelikos, N. and Gounaris, S. (2015), "Linking key account management practices to performance outcomes", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 45 No. 1, pp. 22–34.
- Ulag, W. (2003), "Capturing value creation in business relationships: a customer perspective", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 32 No. 8, pp. 677–693.
- Upadhyay, N., Upadhyay, S. and Dwivedi, Y.K. (2022), "Theorizing artificial intelligence acceptance and digital entrepreneurship model", *International Journal of Entrepreneurial Behavior & Research*, Vol. 28 No. 5, pp. 1138–1166.
- Venkatesh, V., Brown, S.A. and Bala, H. (2013), "Bridging the qualitative/quantitative divide: guidelines for conducting mixed methods research in information systems", *MIS Quarterly*, Vol. 37, No. 1, pp. 21–54.
- Vorhies, D.W. and Morgan, N.A. (2005), "Benchmarking marketing capabilities for sustainable competitive advantage", *Journal of Marketing*, Vol. 69, No. 1, pp. 80–94.
- Wamba-Taguimdje, S.L., Fosso Wamba, S., Kala Kamdjoug, J.R. and Tchatchouang Wanko, C.E. (2020), "Influence of artificial intelligence (AI) on firm performance: the business value of AI-based transformation projects", *Business Process Management Journal*, Vol. 26 No. 7, pp. 1893–1924.
- Waytz, A., Cacioppo, J. and Epley, N. (2010), "Who sees human? The stability and importance of individual differences in anthropomorphism", *Perspectives on Psychological Science*, Vol. 5 No. 3, pp. 219–232.
- Wei, R. and Pardo, C. (2022), "Artificial intelligence and SMEs: how can B2B SMEs leverage AI platforms to integrate AI technologies?", *Industrial Marketing Management*, Vol. 107, pp. 466–483.
- Woodall, T. (2003), "Conceptualising 'value for the customer': an attributional, structural and dispositional analysis", *Academy of Marketing Science Review*, Vol. 12 No. 1, pp. 1–42.
- Xu, J. and Lu, W. (2022), "Developing a human-organization-technology fit model for information technology adoption in organizations", *Technology in Society*, Vol. 70, p. 102010.
- Xu, J., Lu, W. and Papadonikolaki, E. (2022), "Human-organization-technology fit model for BIM adoption in construction project organizations: impact factor analysis using SNA and comparative case study", *Journal of Management in Engineering*, Vol. 38 No. 3, p. 4022004.

Further reading

- Dijkstra, T.K. and Henseler, J. (2015), "Consistent partial least squares path modelling", *MIS quarterly*, Vol. 39 No. 2, pp. 297–316.
- Shankar, A., Jebarajakirthy, C. and Ashaduzzaman, M. (2020), "How do electronic word of mouth practices contribute to mobile banking adoption?", *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, Vol. 52, p. 101920.

Appendix 1. Interview questions for qualitative analysis

Interview guide

- 1 Generic questions:
 - Discuss about the company and the industry in a broader sense.
 - Discuss regarding the job roles and industry experience of yours as a key account manager.
- 2 Initial interview guide:
 - What is your level of understanding about artificial intelligence?
 - Can you elaborate on how AI has impacted your understanding of the processes within your organisation?
 - What factors led to the shift or transformation towards AI in your business and industry?
- 3 Final interview guide:
 - How does different personality traits influence their perception and adoption of AI technologies in their role?

- Which personality traits impact the approach to using AI for enhancing customer relationships and services?
- Could you elaborate on how your level of conscientiousness influences your interaction with AI tools designed to enhance business processes?
- How does neuroticism affect your attitude towards the implementation of AI technologies in your organisation?
- How does one's openness to experience impact their level of enthusiasm for exploring and adopting new AI solutions in their work?

- What factors have led to the adoption of AI technologies in your organisation and how they have affected your role.
- How has the implementation of AI technologies helped your business operations gain a competitive advantage?
- How has the adoption of AI impacted the overall performance of your firm?
- What impact does the organisational culture have on the adoption and integration of AI technologies within your company?

Source: Authors' own work

Appendix 2

Table A1 Themes extracted from interview excerpts

SN	Second-order themes	First-order codes	Interview excerpts
1	Extraversion	Balancing excitement with tangible advantages	I am particularly receptive to AI technologies that enhance social interactions, such as chatbots and virtual assistants, as I find them engaging and useful I love using AI tools that promote collaboration and enhance communication, as they perfectly complement my warm and energetic personality Nevertheless, there are instances where I must strike a balance between my excitement for innovative AI solutions and the need to prioritise their tangible advantages for the organisation
2	Agreeableness	Aligns with agreeable disposition	I have a deep appreciation for AI technologies that enhance customer service and user experiences while upholding ethical practices and fostering positive relationships I am in favour of AI initiatives that prioritise societal harmony and user satisfaction, which aligns with my agreeable disposition I strongly believe in the widespread implementation of user-centric AI solutions throughout the company
3	Conscientiousness	Enhance organisation and discipline	I am driven to adopt AI tools that enhance organisation, discipline and accuracy in business processes I appreciate AI systems that streamline repetitive tasks, enhance operational efficiency and enhance data management, as they resonate with my systematic approach I have become an enthusiastic proponent of AI technologies that enhance productivity and streamline processes
4	Neuroticism	Cautious rather than fully embracing	I approach the adoption of AI technologies with caution and a healthy dose of scepticism, especially when it comes to their potential effects on job security and privacy There are times when I experience a sense of unease regarding the potential risks that come with the implementation of AI This can sometimes lead me to approach these solutions with caution rather than fully embracing them. To address these concerns, I am in search of thorough information and reassurances regarding the safety and advantages of AI
5	Openness	Exploring innovative AI solutions enthusiastically	Exploring and adopting innovative AI solutions across various domains such as art, education and entertainment is fuelled by my openness to experience and enthusiasm I am enthusiastic about the potential of AI to inspire innovative and imaginative approaches within the organisation I am always driven by curiosity, constantly seeking new ways to push the boundaries of AI applications
6	Adoption of AI technologies	Embraced AI for enhanced efficiency	Our organisation has embraced AI technologies to enhance efficiency and enable data-driven decision-making These technologies have greatly improved operational efficiency, minimised the need for manual labour and offered valuable insights through the use of predictive analytics Due to its significance, AI has become a crucial component of our strategic initiatives and daily operations
7	Competitive advantage	AI-driven solutions will provide the edge amongst other competitors	AI technologies have played a crucial role in improving our competitive advantage through process optimisation and fostering innovation Being able to analyse large datasets and gain insights has enabled us to make well-informed decisions and stay ahead of market trends Our company stands out from competitors by offering customised AI-driven solutions that have significantly enhanced customer satisfaction

(continued)

Table A1

SN	Second-order themes	First-order codes	Interview excerpts
8	Firm performance	Improved profitability and competitiveness enhance company performance	Our firm's performance has been significantly improved by the integration of AI, resulting in increased productivity and more efficient resource allocation Automated processes and data-driven strategies have resulted in significant cost savings and improved profitability In general, AI has allowed us to achieve improved financial outcomes and a more competitive market position
9	Organisational culture	Openness and collaboration drive competitiveness which creates good culture	Our organisational culture, with a strong focus on innovation and adaptability, has played a crucial role in enabling the successful integration of AI technologies An environment that fosters support and encourages experimentation and collective problem-solving has greatly expedited the integration of AI The culture of openness and collaboration has played a crucial role in effectively harnessing AI for gaining a competitive edge

Source: Authors' own work

Appendix 3

Table A2 Items and sources for quantitative analysis

Factors	Source	Items	Items code
Extraversion (EXT)	(Costa and McCrae, 2006)	I believe I am an extroverted and sociable person	EXT3
		I am gregarious and possess an assertive personality	EXT2
		I generate considerable enthusiasm	EXT1
Agreeableness (AGR)		I am considerate towards nearly everyone and enjoy collaborating with others	AGR3
		I am always considerate and selfless towards others	AGR2
		I am a tolerant person	AGR1
Conscientiousness (CON)	(Costa and McCrae, 2006; Mahlamäki et al., 2019)	I will work diligently	COS4
		I perform tasks efficiently	COS3
		I adhere to my schedule	COS2
		I am a trustworthy individual	COS1
Neuroticism (NEU)		I'm not overly anxious	NEU3
		I never become agitated	NEU2
		I am not readily frightened, and generally composed in stressful situations	NEU1
Openness (OPE)		I am creative	OPE3
		I am receptive to novel concepts	OPE2
		I prefer to perform difficult tasks	OPE1
Adoption of AI technologies (AAT)	(Gunasekaran et al., 2017)	The degree to which you believe that adopting AI technologies helps you enhance your job performance	AAT3
		The degree to which you and your colleagues associate with the AI technologies	AAT2
		The degree to which you believe that an organisational and technical infrastructure exists to support use of the AI technologies	AAT1
Competitive advantage (CMA)	(Vorhies and Morgan, 2005)	We deliver value to our customers	CMA3
		Our market share has grown significantly relative to our customers	CMA2
		We are able to acquire new customers	CMA1
Firm performance (FMP)	(Gunasekaran et al., 2017)	Average return on investment	FMP3
		Average profit	FMP2
		Average profit	FMP1
Organisational culture (ORC)	(Huey Yiing and Zaman Bin Ahmad, 2009)	We feel that mutual respect among team members are important	ORC3
		We feel that information sharing among team members are important	ORC2
		We are willingness to accept change in the organisational structure	ORC1

Source: Authors' own work

About the authors

Prashant Mehta is a faculty member at Symbiosis Centre for Management Studies, Noida, India.

Debarun Chakraborty, PhD is an Associate Professor of Symbiosis Institute of Business Management, Nagpur which is a constituent of Symbiosis International (Deemed University), Pune, India. He has published works on technology adoption, consumer behaviour, sustainability, etc., in high impact factor journals. His research appears in *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, *Journal of Hospitality Marketing and Management*, *Technovation*, *International*

Journal of Consumer Studies, *Journal of Computer Information Systems* and *British Food Journal* among others.

Nripendra P. Rana is a Professor in Digital Marketing and Strategies at Queen's Business School, Queen's University Belfast, UK. He did his MBA as well as PhD from Swansea University, UK. He has also worked as Professor in Information Systems at Swansea University, UK and the Head of International Business, Marketing and Branding Research Centre and a Professor in Digital Marketing at the University of Bradford in the UK. His current research interests focus primarily on adoption and diffusion of emerging ICTs, e-commerce, m-commerce, e-government

and digital, social media marketing and role of artificial intelligence on consumer decision-making and behaviour. He has published more than 350 research papers in a range of leading academic journals, conference proceedings, books etc. Some of such journals where his papers got published include *British Journal of Management*, *European Journal of Information Systems*, *Annals of Tourism Research*, *Public Management Review*, *European Journal of Marketing*, *Journal of Sustainable Tourism* and *International Journal of Information Management* to name a few. He has also co-edited several special issues, organised tracks, mini-tracks and panels in leading conferences. Nripendra P. Rana is the corresponding author and can be contacted at: nrananp@gmail.com

Anubhav Mishra is working as a Professor (Marketing) at Jaipuria Institute of Management, Lucknow. He is a Fellow of Marketing from IIM, Lucknow. He has published in various highly ranked national and international journals, such as *International Journal of Information Management*, *Journal of Business Research*, *Psychology and Marketing*, *Journal of Consumer Marketing*, *Journal of Consumer Behavior*, *Marketing Intelligence and Planning* and *Journal of Services Marketing*. His research interests include online consumer behaviour, electronic word-of-mouth, fake reviews, emerging technologies and technology adoption.

Sangeeta Khorana is a Professor of International Trade Policy at the Aston Business School at Aston University, UK. He is an international trade expert with 25+ years of academia

and management consulting experience including, between 1993 and 2001 as a civil servant with the government of India. Prof Khorana leads research on international trade policy, in particular on free trade agreement (FTA) negotiations and WTO issues. She has advised EU institutions on FTA negotiations with India and Vietnam as well as developed methodologies for liberalisation through FTA negotiations. Prof Khorana has undertaken funded research for the UK Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC), Welsh Assembly, Foreign and Commonwealth Office, European Commission, DG Trade, Commonwealth Secretariat, InterAmerican Development Bank (IADB), World Bank-ITCLO, UNCTAD-India and the Swiss Federal Government among others.

Kaouther Kooli is an Associate Professor in Marketing in the Department of Marketing, Strategy and Innovation at the Faculty of Management, Bournemouth University. She holds a PhD in Marketing. She has over 18 years of higher education teaching experience acquired in Tunisia, UK and France. Her research interests are in digital B2B marketing, digital marketing and consumer behaviour. She is an expert in both quantitative and qualitative research methods. She is a Senior Editor of the marketing section of Cogent Business and Management, a member of the editorial board of the *Journal of Business-to-Business Marketing* and the curator board of the *Journal of Customer Behaviour*.